

LoveBETTER Content Archive

Generated: 27 June 2026 | Total Posts: 277
Pending: 262 | Ready: 15

Post 1

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-05-30

LinkedIn:

This is my first LinkedIn post via the automation pipeline. Excited to share what I've been building lately!

Post 2

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-05-30

LinkedIn:

Most couples don't need to break up. They need to reconnect.

I've spent years working with couples who walk into my practice thinking they're broken.

They're not.

They're disconnected.

Disconnection isn't a character flaw ? it's a signal. A signal that somewhere along the line, the inner child took the wheel. And that child doesn't know how to communicate. It knows how to protect.

At FOLA, we don't teach couples to "fight better." We teach them to see each other again.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is where that starts. 15 minutes. Two people. One honest look at where you actually are.

No judgment. Just clarity.

If you're in a relationship and something feels off ? trust that feeling. It's trying to tell you something.

Facebook:

Most couples don't need to break up. They need to reconnect.

I see it every day in my practice ? couples walk in thinking they're broken. They're not. They're just disconnected.

Disconnection isn't a character flaw. It's a signal. Somewhere along the line, the inner child took the wheel. And that child doesn't know how to communicate ? it knows how to protect.

At FOLA, we don't teach couples to fight better. We teach them to see each other again.

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If something feels off in your relationship ? trust that feeling. It's trying to tell you something.

<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 3

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-05-31

LinkedIn:

Most couples walk into my practice saying the same thing: 'We don't know what's wrong, we just know something is off.'

They're not wrong. They're just missing data.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is a 14-page clinical diagnostic report that measures 7 domains of your relationship ? Attachment Style, Trauma Inventory, Neurodivergence indicators, Values Alignment, Change Readiness, Communication Patterns, and Future Vision.

Each partner answers separately. The report shows you where you align, where you diverge, and ? most importantly ? what to do about it.

It's R600. It takes 30 minutes. And it ends the guessing.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_original

Facebook:

Most couples say the same thing when they walk in: "We don't know what's wrong, we just know something is off."

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<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 4

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-01

LinkedIn:

Here's what the LoveBETTER Assessment reveals that most couples never see: the gap between how you see the relationship and how your partner sees it.

I've watched couples sit with their report and realise they've been living in completely different relationships. One partner thinks communication is fine (10/10). The other scores it a 3/10. They've been having two different conversations for years.

The report doesn't pick sides. It shows the data. And the data is usually the first honest conversation they've had in a long time.

7 domains. 14 pages. One truth you can actually work with.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_original

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The report doesn't pick sides. It shows the data. And the data is usually the first honest conversation they've had in a long time.

Have you ever wondered if you and your partner are on the same page?

<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 5

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-02

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous gap in a relationship isn't communication. It's change readiness.

I've seen couples where one partner scores 9/10 on readiness ? they're all in, ready to do the work, ready to show up. The other scores 2/10 ? not because they don't care, but because they don't see the problem.

That 7-point gap is a fracture. One person is running toward growth. The other doesn't know there's a race.

The LoveBETTER Assessment flags this specifically. It tells you not just where you are, but whether you're both ready to move in the same direction.

Because effort without alignment is just two people running alone.

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Facebook:

The most dangerous gap in a relationship isn't communication. It's change readiness.

I've seen couples where one partner is all in ? ready to do the work, ready to show up. The other isn't there yet. Not because they don't care, but because they don't see the problem.

That gap is a fracture. One person is running toward growth. The other doesn't know there's a race.

The LoveBETTER Assessment flags this specifically. It tells you not just where you are, but whether you're both ready to move in the same direction.

Because effort without alignment is just two people running alone.

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Post 6

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-03

LinkedIn:

Your partner's reactions that don't make sense? The ones that seem too big for the moment?
They're not about the moment.

They're about something that happened long before you met.

The LoveBETTER Assessment includes a Trauma Inventory domain. It measures how much each partner is carrying ? and whether those loads are compatible.

I've had couples break down reading this section. Not because it's harsh. Because for the first time, they understand why they keep hitting the same wall.

One partner's trauma score was 8/10. The other's was 6.4/10. The gap was 1.6 points ? small on paper, massive in how they showed up for each other.

The report doesn't just name it. It gives you a clinical pathway forward.

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Post 7

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-04

LinkedIn:

There's very little clinical research on Black South African relationships. Most couple's therapy models were developed in Europe and America, tested on white populations, and imported here without adjustment.

That's a problem.

Because the history we carry ? forced removals, migrant labour, pass laws, families separated for generations ? shaped how we attach, how we communicate, how we trust. You can't apply a framework built in Connecticut to a couple from Soweto and expect it to hold.

The LoveBETTER Assessment was built here. It accounts for the cultural and historical architecture that standard models miss.

Not imported. Built for us.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_original

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Post 8

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-05

LinkedIn:

R600.

That's the price of the LoveBETTER Assessment. Let me tell you what R600 buys in South Africa right now:

- A takeaway dinner for two, with delivery
- Half a tank of petrol
- A month of Netflix, Showmax, and Spotify combined
- One round of drinks at a halfway decent spot

Or ? 30 minutes that could change the trajectory of your relationship.

A 14-page clinical report. 7 domains measured. Partner-by-partner comparison. Clinical flags. A phased pathway with specific recommendations. Journal prompts to start the conversation.

Most couples spend more on the dinner where they don't talk about what's actually wrong than they would on the assessment that names it.

R600 is not expensive. Staying stuck is.

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Or ? 30 minutes that could change the trajectory of your relationship.

A 14-page clinical report. 7 relationship domains measured. A clear pathway forward.

What's costing you more ? the assessment or staying where you are?

<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 9

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-06

LinkedIn:

I'm building FOLA in full view because I think South Africans deserve better relationship tools than what's currently available.

Most couple's therapy is a black box. You go in, you talk, you leave, you hope something shifted. There's no baseline. No measurement. No way to know if you're actually making progress.

The LoveBETTER Assessment changes that. It gives you a starting point ? clinical, specific, measurable. 7 domains scored. Gaps identified. A pathway designed.

This week I'll be sharing the numbers. How many assessments we've sold. What couples are discovering. What's working and what's not.

If you're building something in South Africa too ? keep going. We need more people solving real problems for real people.

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Facebook:

I'm building FOLA in full view because I think South African couples deserve better than imported relationship advice.

No polished launch. No waiting until everything is perfect. Just building it publicly, learning as I go.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is live. It works. Couples are using it to understand their relationships better than ever before.

If you've been following along, this is your sign to stop watching and start. Your relationship is the project that matters most.

<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 10

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-07

LinkedIn:

The paradox of hard work in relationships:

Most couples think 'trying harder' is the answer. More conversations. More date nights. More effort.

But trying harder at the wrong thing is just efficient failure.

I see couples who've been 'working on it' for years ? same arguments, same patterns, same frustration. They're not lazy. They're working hard in the wrong direction.

The LoveBETTER Assessment doesn't ask you to try harder. It shows you exactly where your effort is wasted and where it actually moves the needle.

7 domains. 14 pages. One truth you can stop guessing about.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_da nkoe

Facebook:

Most couples think they need to try harder. More effort. More conversations. More date nights.

But here's what I've learned: most couples are already working hard ? just in the wrong direction.

They're fixing symptoms instead of addressing root causes. Arguing about tone of voice when the real issue is attachment style. Fighting about money when the real issue is values alignment.

The LoveBETTER Assessment doesn't ask you to try harder. It shows you exactly where your effort is wasted and where it actually moves the needle.

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Post 11

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-08

LinkedIn:

I've noticed something about Black South African couples who come to my practice.

They're not afraid of hard conversations. They've had plenty. What they're afraid of is the conversation that reveals they've been in different relationships all along.

She thinks communication is fine. He thinks it's broken. They're both right ? about their own experience. But neither one has seen the other's data.

The LoveBETTER Assessment gives both partners the same report. Same numbers. Same gaps. Same pathway forward.

For the first time, you're not arguing about who's right. You're looking at the same truth and deciding what to do about it.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_da nkoe

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Post 12

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-09

LinkedIn:

Here's the exact system I use with every couple who takes the LoveBETTER Assessment:

Step 1: Both partners answer separately (20 min). No conferring. No editing each other's answers.

Step 2: The report generates ? 7 domains scored, partner-by-partner comparison, clinical flags identified.

Step 3: You sit with the report alone first. Journal on the prompts provided. Let it land before you talk about it.

Step 4: You come together and discuss what surprised you, what hurt, and what gave you hope.

Step 5: The clinical pathway gives you a phased plan ? individual work first if needed, then couples integration, then maintenance.

Most couples skip to Step 4 without doing Step 3. That's where the real work lives.

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Ready for Step 1? <https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 13

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-10

LinkedIn:

The most intelligent thing you can do for your relationship is focus on fewer things.

Not more date nights. Not another conversation about 'where this is going.' Not reading another relationship book.

One assessment. 30 minutes. 7 domains.

Most couples spread their attention across a hundred symptoms ? the tone of voice, the late nights, the money, the in-laws ? and never look at the root.

The LoveBETTER Assessment collapses all that noise into one signal. Your attachment pattern. Your trauma load. Your readiness for change.

Focus is the new IQ. Even in love.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_da nkoe

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Post 14

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-11

LinkedIn:

The version of me from 3 years ago is my ideal client.

That's the Dan Koe framework I've stolen for FOLA. You don't research customer personas. You serve the person you used to be.

Three years ago I was a practitioner who couldn't find a relationship assessment built for African couples. Everything was imported from Europe or America ? frameworks designed for a different history, a different culture, a different people.

So I built one.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is the tool I wished existed when I started. 7 domains. Clinical rigor. Built in South Africa for South Africans.

Your ideal client is you, 1-2 years ago. Build for them.

[https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_da
nkoe](https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_da
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If you're where I was 3 years ago ? looking for something that actually fits ? this is for you.

<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 15

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-12

LinkedIn:

Most couples are trapped in a system they didn't choose.

Not by their partner. By the algorithm.

You scroll past relationship advice that doesn't apply to you. You watch couples on Instagram who seem perfect. You absorb the message that if it's hard, it's wrong.

That's digital serfdom for your love life. You're consuming content designed for engagement, not for your actual relationship.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is the off-ramp. It's not content. It's data about your specific relationship. Not generic advice. A clinical pathway designed for your scores, your gaps, your next step.

Stop scrolling for answers. Get yours.

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<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 16

Status: ready | Scheduled: 2026-06-13

LinkedIn:

Most people know what they want in a relationship.

Very few know what they're trying to avoid.

Dan Koe calls it the Anti-Vision ? the future you definitely don't want. The silence at the dinner table. The resentment you can't name. The feeling of being alone in a room with someone you used to love.

Your Anti-Vision is more powerful than your goals. Because pain avoidance is stronger than pleasure seeking.

The LoveBETTER Assessment shows you what you're actually up against. Not the surface-level stuff. The domains that, left unchecked, become the future you're afraid of.

You don't have to guess what's coming. The data is right here.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_dankoe

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The silence at the dinner table. The resentment you can't name. The feeling of being alone in a room with someone you used to love.

That future you don't want is more powerful than any goal. Because pain avoidance is stronger than pleasure seeking.

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<https://lovebetter.co.za/>

Post 17

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-08

LinkedIn:

Your brain isn't broken. It's still at war.

You thought it was laziness. Or weakness. Or the peculiar shame of being someone who can't simply get it together.

But here's what nobody told you: when a body has been through sustained stress ? or the

slow, quiet violence of a childhood where safety was never guaranteed ? the brain reroutes. It pulls energy from the prefrontal cortex (decision-making, regulation, sleep) and sends it to the amygdala. The survival centre.

This isn't pathology. It's genius.

Your body is trying to keep you alive. The problem is the war is over ? and nobody told your body.

At FOLA, we work with the nervous system, not against it. We don't treat symptoms as character flaws. We treat them as signals.

If you've been carrying something you can't name, the first step is understanding what you're actually carrying.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 18

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-08

LinkedIn:

There is a man I know ? I know many versions of him ? who cannot go to sleep until everyone in his house is okay.

He checks the doors. The finances. His phone for messages from people who may need something. He has learned that the way to feel safe is to make himself indispensable.

If he is needed, he cannot be left.

He calls this love. Most people around him call it love too.

It is a wound wearing a costume.

The care is genuine. But underneath it is a child who learned, very early, that his value depended on what he could do for others. Not on who he was.

This is not a character flaw. It is a survival strategy that has outlived its usefulness.

At FOLA, we help men untangle the difference between genuine care and compulsive rescue. Between love and the fear of being left.

That distinction changes everything.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 19

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-09

LinkedIn:

I want to tell you this before it happens, so that when it does, you don't interpret it as failure.

When you start to get well ? actually well, not the surface version where you have better language for your patterns but the same patterns ? the people around you will respond.

Some will become uncomfortable. Some will pull back without being able to explain why. Some will accuse you of changing, as though change was the betrayal and not the wound

they've been benefiting from.

This is not a reason to stop.

The relationships in your life were built around a specific version of you. When that version starts to heal, the system reorganises. Not everyone makes it through the reorganisation.

That doesn't mean the healing was wrong. It means the container wasn't built for who you're becoming.

At FOLA, we prepare people for this. Because the loneliness of outgrowing your old life is real ? and you shouldn't have to navigate it alone.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 20

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-09

LinkedIn:

You have forgiven yourself.

You said the words. You did the session. You cried the cry that felt like it came from somewhere very deep and very old. And you thought: that's it, that's the thing I needed to release.

And then something happened ? a conversation, a look, a small thing that should not have carried the weight it carried ? and there you were again. Holding the same thing.

You will probably tell yourself you didn't do it right. That the forgiveness wasn't real.

Stop.

What you are describing is not failure. It is the difference between an event and a practice.

Forgiveness is not a transaction you complete. It is a muscle you build. Every time you return to the same wound and choose not to make it mean something about your worth, you are not failing. You are strengthening.

At FOLA, we teach self-forgiveness as a practice ? not a performance.

Because healing doesn't happen in a single session. It happens in the thousands of small choices you make after.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 21

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-10

LinkedIn:

I know what you're thinking. You've heard the phrase. You've categorised it ? gently ? as the soft end of the therapeutic world.

I need to correct that.

The inner child is not a metaphor. It is a neurological reality.

Between the ages of zero and six, the brain operates in a state researchers have compared to hypnosis. The prefrontal cortex ? critical thinking, evaluation, the ability to say "that's not true about me" ? is essentially offline. The child is a receiver. Everything goes in without filtering.

The parent who loves fiercely but rages when overwhelmed? That goes in. The silence after something bad happened? That goes in. The message that you are too much, not enough, responsible for everyone else's feelings? All of it. Unfiltered. Unquestioned.

And then, decades later, you wonder why you react to certain situations as though you are still small.

Because part of you is.

At FOLA, we work with the inner child not as regression, but as reorganisation. We go back to the original recording and update the file.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 22

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-10

LinkedIn:

Money gives you a handle on the door.

It does not tell you what is on the other side.

I have watched enough people come into resources ? real resources, the kind that change the material texture of a life ? to say this with certainty: money does not heal wounds. Money amplifies what is already present.

If the wound is still open when the money arrives, the money makes the wound louder. More room to run. More distractions with higher production values. More people willing to agree with you, because disagreeing now has a cost.

Poverty is a wound. I don't want to be misread. The chronic scarcity that marks so many Black lives ? the monthly arithmetic of not enough ? that is real, and it leaves its own kind of damage.

But money alone does not undo that damage. It just changes the neighbourhood where the damage lives.

At FOLA, we help people do both: build the resource and heal the wound. Because one without the other is just a more comfortable version of the same prison.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 23

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-11

LinkedIn:

There is a moment ? most of us know it ? when a feeling arrives so loudly that it becomes the only truth in the room.

The voice that says: this is over. Or: they do not care about you. Or: you are alone in this.

The feeling arrives with the confidence of evidence. It does not announce itself as interpretation. It announces itself as fact.

And you act from it. Or you collapse into it. Or you carry it around for days, quietly poisoning every interaction from inside it.

I want to give you a tool I use in sessions.

When a client arrives inside one of these certainties, I ask them to do a pre-mortem. Before you act on the feeling, test it against the truth. What is the evidence ? not the emotion, the evidence ? that this is real? What would you tell a friend who came to you with this same certainty?

Most of the time, the feeling is not wrong. It's just incomplete. It's a signal, not a verdict.

At FOLA, we teach people to read their feelings without being ruled by them. To distinguish between what you feel and what is true.

That distinction is a superpower.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 24

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-11

LinkedIn:

There is a particular kind of exhaustion that comes from having to narrate your own interior in real time.

You know this exhaustion. The exhaustion of being in a conversation where you can feel that you are not okay ? where something has shifted, where the person in front of you has said something that landed in a place you did not expect ? and instead of saying that, you say nothing. Or you say fine. Or you reroute into a version of the conversation that keeps everyone comfortable except you.

You have been doing this for a very long time.

It probably started as survival. Somewhere in your early life, you learned that expressing what was actually happening inside you produced results you couldn't handle. So you learned to manage. To smooth over. To perform okay.

Healing requires you to stop explaining yourself to people who are not equipped to receive what you're saying.

At FOLA, we help people reclaim the right to be seen without having to justify it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 25

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-12

LinkedIn:

I am going to write something practitioners are not supposed to write.

I know exactly what is wrong. With my practice. With the gap between what the work

produces in the room and what the infrastructure around the room can hold. I know the names of the systems that are not working. I know what the website should say. I know what the person on the other side of it needs to feel before they will pick up the phone.

I know all of this. And there are days when none of it is moving and I am sitting in the middle of my own knowing and it is the loneliest place in the world.

People assume clarity is comfort. That if you can see the problem, you are close to solving it.

They are not wrong, exactly. But they are not right either.

Clarity without capacity is its own kind of grief.

I share this because I think more practitioners need to say it out loud. The work of building a practice that actually serves people ? not just the ones who can afford it, not just the ones who already understand the language ? is slow. It is unglamorous. And it is worth it.

At FOLA, we are building something that holds both the clinical rigour and the human truth. If that resonates, you know where to find me.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 26

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-12

LinkedIn:

Start with the resentment.

Not the kindness ? everybody starts with the kindness. Everybody leads with how much they give, how much they help, how available they are. They lead with the generosity. And it is real.

But follow the generosity far enough and you always hit the resentment. The specific, hot, slightly shameful resentment of someone who keeps giving without being asked and then cannot understand why nobody is giving back at the same volume.

Someone who keeps saying yes until they cannot, and then when they finally say no, they are treated ? or they feel they are treated ? as though the no was a betrayal.

People-pleasing is not kindness. It is a wound wearing a costume.

The generosity is real. But the engine behind it is fear. Fear of rejection. Fear of conflict. Fear that your value depends on what you provide.

At FOLA, we help people untangle the generosity from the fear. So you can give from fullness instead of from emptiness.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 27

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-13

LinkedIn:

Most people approach personal optimisation backwards.

They start with productivity systems. Morning routines. Biohacking. The latest protocol for getting more out of a 24-hour day.

And then they wonder why none of it sticks.

Here's what nobody tells you about optimisation: you cannot optimise a system that is still in survival mode.

If your nervous system is scanning for threats, no amount of cold plunges or Notion templates will give you focus. If your inner architecture is organised around protection, the most elegant productivity system in the world will collapse the first time you feel unsafe.

Real optimisation starts with regulation. Not discipline. Not hustle. The ability to return to baseline when life gets loud.

At FOLA, we build the foundation first. Nervous system regulation. Attachment repair. Inner child reorganisation. Then we build the performance layer on top.

Because you cannot out-discipline a dysregulated nervous system.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 28

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-13

LinkedIn:

Self-mastery is not what you think it is.

It is not the ability to suppress your emotions in a meeting. It is not the capacity to push through exhaustion. It is not the discipline to wake up at 4 AM and grind while everything inside you is screaming for rest.

That is not mastery. That is dissociation with a productivity aesthetic.

Real self-mastery is the ability to feel what you feel without being controlled by it. To notice the impulse to react ? and choose a response instead. To sit with discomfort long enough to understand what it's telling you, rather than numbing, distracting, or performing your way past it.

Mastery is not the absence of chaos. It is the capacity to remain centred inside it.

At FOLA, we teach self-mastery as an inside-out practice. Regulation first. Awareness second. Action third.

Anything else is just performance.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 29

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-14

LinkedIn:

I started FOLA because I got tired of watching people spend years in therapy without a roadmap.

Not because the therapy was bad. Because the therapy was blind.

Most people enter healing without a baseline. They don't know what's actually wrong ? they just know something hurts. They don't know if they're making progress ? they just know some weeks feel better than others.

That's not healing. That's hoping.

At FOLA, we start with data. Clinical assessments that measure what's actually happening. Attachment patterns. Trauma load. Nervous system state. Values alignment. Change readiness.

Then we build a pathway. Not a generic protocol. A specific, phased plan based on what the data reveals.

And we measure progress. Not by how you feel on a Tuesday. By whether the numbers are moving in the right direction.

This is what happens when you put clinical rigour at the centre of the healing conversation.

If you're ready to stop guessing and start knowing, book a discovery call.

<https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 30

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-14

LinkedIn:

Here's what I know after years of sitting across from people who are doing the work:

Healing is not a straight line. It is not a destination you arrive at and then everything is fine. It is a continuous, unglamorous, deeply courageous practice of showing up for yourself even when nobody is watching.

Some weeks you will feel like you've undone all your progress. You haven't. You're just in a new layer of the same work.

Some weeks you will feel like nobody understands what you're going through. You're right ? they don't. But that doesn't mean you're alone.

Some weeks you will want to quit. Don't.

The version of you that started this journey deserves to see what's on the other side.

At FOLA, we don't just help you start the work. We help you stay in it long enough for it to change your life.

If you've been waiting for a sign to begin ? this is it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 31

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-16

LinkedIn:

You can talk about a wound for ten years and still not heal it.

Not because the talking is useless. Because some wounds are not stored in the part of the

brain that responds to language.

Trauma is stored in the body. In the nervous system. In the way your shoulders tense when a certain tone of voice enters the room. In the way your chest tightens when someone moves too close too fast. In the way you go quiet, or loud, or numb ? before you have even decided to respond.

This is not a failure of insight. You can understand your pattern perfectly and still be unable to change it in the moment. Because the body does not wait for the mind to catch up.

At FOLA, we work somatically. We don't just talk about what happened. We help the body release what it has been holding.

Because the wound lives in the tissue. That's where the healing has to go.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 32

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-16

LinkedIn:

Someone in your life probably calls you the strong one.

It sounds like a compliment. It is not always one.

Being the strong one means you are the person who absorbs. The one who holds everyone else's feelings without having anywhere to put your own. The one who is expected to be okay ? not because you are okay, but because if you are not okay, the whole system wobbles.

And so you learn to perform okay. You learn to say "I'm fine" in a voice that convinces everyone except the person who matters most ? you.

The strong one is not strong. The strong one is the one who has learned that no one is coming to hold them.

At FOLA, we help people who have been carrying everyone else learn how to put the weight down. Not because you stop caring. Because you deserve to be held too.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 33

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-17

LinkedIn:

Your attachment style is not a personality trait. It is a survival blueprint.

It was built in the first years of your life, before you had language, before you had choice, before you could say "this is not good for me." Your nervous system learned what to expect from relationships based on what it received.

If care was consistent, you learned that people are safe.

If care was unpredictable, you learned to cling or to guard.

If care was absent, you learned to need no one ? because needing hurt too much.

And now, as an adult, you wonder why you keep repeating the same patterns. Why you attract people who confirm what you already believe about love.

You are not broken. You are following a blueprint that kept you safe once. The problem is the blueprint is outdated.

At FOLA, we help you rewrite it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 34

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-17

LinkedIn:

The gap between knowing what to do and actually doing it is not a character flaw. It is a neurological gap.

You can know that your reaction is disproportionate. You can know that your partner is not your parent. You can know that the threat is not real. And still ? your body acts as though it is.

This is not a failure of will. It is a failure of integration. The part of you that knows is not connected to the part of you that reacts.

Healing is the process of closing that gap. Not through more information ? you already have enough of that. Through practice. Repetition. The slow, unglamorous work of teaching your nervous system a new response.

At FOLA, we don't just give you insight. We give you a pathway to embody it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 35

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18

LinkedIn:

Most of us were taught that anger is dangerous.

We were taught to suppress it. To apologise for it. To translate it into something more palatable ? frustration, disappointment, exhaustion ? because the raw version was too much for the people around us.

But here's what nobody told you: anger is not the enemy. Anger is a signal.

It tells you when a boundary has been crossed. When something is not right. When you have been asked to carry something that was never yours to carry.

The problem is not that you feel anger. The problem is that you were never taught what to do with it.

Suppressed anger does not disappear. It turns into resentment. Into passive aggression. Into the quiet, slow erosion of your health and your relationships.

At FOLA, we help people learn to be with their anger without being controlled by it. To let it inform without letting it destroy.

Because anger is not the opposite of peace. Repressed anger is.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 36

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18

LinkedIn:

Most people think therapy changes what you think.

It doesn't. At least not primarily.

Therapy changes what you feel safe enough to do.

You can know, intellectually, that you are worthy of love. But if your nervous system learned, in the first years of your life, that love is conditional ? that it depends on what you achieve, how you perform, how well you manage everyone else's feelings ? then knowing your worth will not be enough. Your body will not believe it.

Real change happens when the body learns a new truth. When you have an experience ? not just an idea ? of being safe, being seen, being held without having to earn it.

That experience rewires the blueprint.

At FOLA, we create the conditions for that experience. Not just insight. Integration.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 37

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-19

LinkedIn:

There is a particular loneliness that comes with being the person everyone comes to for healing.

You hold space. You carry stories. You sit with pain that other people cannot look at directly. And you do it well ? because you have done your own work, because you know the terrain, because you have walked through your own fire.

But who holds space for you?

This is not a complaint. It is an observation. The people who heal others often have the most sophisticated survival strategies. They learned early to attend to everyone else's needs because theirs were not being met. They became good at holding because no one held them.

At FOLA, we believe that healers need healing too. That the person in the room is as important as the method. That your capacity to hold others depends on your willingness to be held.

If you are a practitioner who has been carrying alone ? this is your sign to find your own container.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 38

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-19

LinkedIn:

We live in a culture that treats grief as a problem to be solved.

There is a timeline. There are stages. There is an expectation that after a certain period, you should be moving on, letting go, finding closure.

But grief is not a problem. Grief is a testimony to love.

The reason it hurts is because it mattered. The reason you cannot simply "get over it" is because the connection was real. Grief is the price of having loved deeply ? and it is not a price you pay once. It is a price you pay every time the loss touches something new.

At FOLA, we don't try to fix grief. We help you carry it. We help you learn to live alongside it without being consumed by it. We help you find the places where joy and grief can coexist.

Because healing is not about getting over. It is about learning to carry.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 39

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-20

LinkedIn:

There is a concept in clinical work called the window of tolerance.

It is the zone in which you can think, feel, and respond without being overwhelmed. When you are inside this window, you can have a difficult conversation without losing your composure. You can hear feedback without collapsing. You can sit with discomfort without needing to escape.

When you are outside this window ? when your nervous system is hyper-aroused (anxious, reactive, flooded) or hypo-aroused (numb, shut down, dissociated) ? you cannot access the parts of your brain that allow you to choose your response.

You are not choosing to react badly. Your window is just too narrow for what life is asking of you.

The goal of therapy is not to eliminate triggers. It is to widen the window. So that more of life fits inside it without breaking you.

At FOLA, we measure and expand the window. Systematically. Clinically. One session at a time.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 40

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-20

LinkedIn:

Most of us spend our lives managing how we are perceived.

We curate. We perform. We show the version of ourselves that is acceptable, successful,

together. And we hide the rest ? the confusion, the fear, the parts of us that don't have a neat narrative.

This is exhausting. Not because the performance is hard ? though it is. But because the part of you that is hidden never stops knowing it is hidden. And it wants to be seen.

The courage to be seen is not about oversharing. It is not about performing vulnerability for an audience. It is about the quiet, terrifying decision to let one person ? a therapist, a partner, a trusted friend ? see what is actually there.

Not the curated version. The real one.

At FOLA, we create a container where you don't have to perform. Where you can be exactly as messy, as complicated, as unfinished as you are.

And that is where the real work begins.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 41

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-21

LinkedIn:

The most underrated performance tool is rest.

Not the kind of rest you take when you have earned it. Not the kind you take when you have finished everything on your list. The kind you take because your nervous system needs it ? regardless of whether the list is done.

We have been sold a story that productivity is moral. That rest is a reward for hard work, not a prerequisite for it. That the people who succeed are the ones who push through, who grind, who never stop.

This is not wisdom. This is a trauma response dressed up as work ethic.

A dysregulated nervous system cannot rest. And a nervous system that cannot rest cannot perform at its highest level. It can survive. It can push. But it cannot create, innovate, or connect in the way that real excellence requires.

At FOLA, we teach rest as a skill. Not as a luxury. As a strategic intervention.

Because you cannot outwork a dysregulated nervous system. You can only regulate it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 42

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-21

LinkedIn:

A boundary is not something you impose on other people. It is something you honour for yourself.

Most of us get this backwards. We think boundaries are about controlling other people's behaviour ? telling them what they can and cannot do. And then we wonder why enforcing them feels like a battle.

A boundary is not "you cannot speak to me that way." A boundary is "if you speak to me

that way, I will remove myself from this conversation."

One is an attempt to control. The other is an act of self-respect.

The difference matters. Because when you understand that boundaries are about your own behaviour ? what you will and will not tolerate, what you will and will not participate in ? they become something you can hold without needing anyone else's cooperation.

At FOLA, we help people build boundaries from the inside out. Not as walls. As the shape of a life you are no longer willing to betray.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 43

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-22

LinkedIn:

FOLA exists because I believe that healing should not be a luxury.

It should not require you to already understand the language. It should not require you to have a certain income, a certain level of insight, a certain tolerance for ambiguity. It should meet you where you are.

That is why we built the LoveBETTER Assessment ? to give couples a clinical starting point without requiring them to commit to months of therapy before they know what they are dealing with.

That is why we offer single sessions alongside packages ? because not everyone knows what they need yet.

That is why we are building content that does not assume you already speak the language of therapy ? because most people don't.

FOLA is not a practice that serves people who already understand healing. It is a practice that makes healing accessible to people who are still wondering if it is for them.

If you have been wondering ? it is.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 44

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-23

LinkedIn:

Grief doesn't always look like tears.

Sometimes it looks like irritability. Like snapping at your partner for leaving the cupboard open. Like road rage that feels bigger than the situation. Like a short fuse you can't explain.

This is unassisted mourning ? grief that has no container, no ritual, no witness. It leaks out sideways because it was never allowed to move through you directly.

Most of us are carrying grief we never named. A version of ourselves we lost. A relationship that ended before we were ready. A childhood that asked too much too soon.

At FOLA, we don't treat symptoms as isolated problems. We trace them back to the grief

they're standing in for.

Because until you mourn what you lost, you'll keep fighting what's here.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 45

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-23

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that has no name in our culture.

It is the grief of becoming someone your family doesn't recognise. Of outgrowing the role you were assigned at birth. Of healing in a way that makes the people who love you uncomfortable.

We have words for losing a person. We don't have words for losing the version of yourself that kept everyone else comfortable.

This is unassisted mourning ? grief that happens alone because there is no ceremony for the person you used to be.

At FOLA, we create space for this kind of grief. Not to fix it. To witness it.

Because what is witnessed can finally rest.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 46

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-24

LinkedIn:

Most couples I work with are not fighting about what they think they're fighting about.

They think it's the money. The parenting. The fact that he doesn't help with the laundry.

But underneath every argument is a grief that hasn't been spoken.

She is grieving the partnership she thought she'd have. He is grieving the freedom he lost. They are both grieving the version of this relationship that existed before the children, before the debt, before the accumulated disappointments of ten years.

And neither one knows how to say: I am sad about what we've lost. Not angry. Sad.

Until that grief is named, every argument is a proxy war.

The LoveBETTER Assessment surfaces these hidden grief points. Not to diagnose. To give you language for what you've been carrying.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 47

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-24

LinkedIn:

You can tell when someone is grieving without permission.

They apologise for their sadness. They say 'I shouldn't still be upset about this.' They minimise their own pain because someone else has it worse.

This is unassisted mourning ? grief that has been denied a proper place in your life because you decided it wasn't valid enough.

Here's what I know: grief doesn't care about your hierarchy of suffering. It doesn't check whether your loss qualifies. It moves through you regardless.

The only question is whether you let it move through you consciously ? or whether it leaks out in ways you don't recognise.

At FOLA, we don't rank pain. We make space for it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 48

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it looks like everything except grief.

It looks like procrastination. Like overworking. Like a sudden disinterest in things you used to love. Like drinking more than you used to. Like scrolling for three hours and not knowing what you're looking for.

Grief that isn't mourned doesn't disappear. It disguises itself.

And because it doesn't look like grief, you don't treat it like grief. You treat it like a character flaw. You tell yourself to try harder, to snap out of it, to be grateful for what you still have.

But gratitude doesn't heal grief. Mourning does.

At FOLA, we help people recognise grief in its disguises. So you can finally give it what it actually needs.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 49

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

There is a particular grief that comes with being the first person in your family to heal.

You are doing something your ancestors could not. You are breaking a pattern that has run through generations. You are learning to feel what your parents could not feel.

And you are doing it alone.

Because the people who love you most may not understand what you're doing. They may see your boundaries as rejection. Your silence as coldness. Your need for space as abandonment.

This is the grief of the pioneer. The one who goes first. The one who carries the weight of healing not just for themselves, but for everyone who comes after.

At FOLA, we see you. We know what this costs.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 50

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-26

LinkedIn:

I have sat with couples where one partner is actively grieving and the other doesn't know.

Not because they're not paying attention. Because the grieving partner has learned to grieve silently. To cry in the shower. To wait until the house is empty. To perform okayness so convincingly that even they believe it.

This is the tragedy of unassisted mourning in relationships. You can be in the same bed as someone who loves you and still grieve alone.

The LoveBETTER Assessment includes a grief inventory ? not because grief is pathological, but because unspoken grief is the most common barrier to intimacy.

You cannot be close to someone who is hiding their sadness from you. Not because you don't want to. Because they won't let you in.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 51

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-26

LinkedIn:

Most of us were taught that grief is something you get over.

You mourn. You heal. You move on. There is a timeline. There is an expectation. There is a version of you on the other side who no longer carries the weight.

This is not how grief works.

Grief is not a problem to be solved. It is a relationship to be maintained. You don't get over a significant loss. You learn to carry it differently. You integrate it. You let it change you.

The people who struggle most with grief are not the ones who feel it too deeply. They are the ones who were told they should be done by now.

At FOLA, we don't rush grief. We companion it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 52

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-27

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that lives in the body.

It is the tightness in your chest when you think about your mother. The knot in your stomach before you visit home. The tension in your shoulders that never fully releases.

You have been carrying this grief for so long you don't notice it anymore. It is just the background hum of your nervous system.

This is unassisted mourning ? grief that was never expressed, never witnessed, never given a voice. It doesn't live in your memories. It lives in your tissues.

At FOLA, we work with the body's grief. Not through talk alone. Through practices that allow the nervous system to finally release what it has been holding.

Because some grief cannot be spoken. It has to be felt.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 53

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-27

LinkedIn:

The most common question I get from people who have experienced loss is: 'How long will this take?'

They want a timeline. A benchmark. A way to measure whether they're grieving correctly.

Here's the answer I give: grief doesn't have a timeline. It has a shape.

Some days the shape is small ? a memory that makes you smile. Some days it fills the entire room. Both are valid. Both are part of the same relationship with what you've lost.

The problem is not that grief takes too long. The problem is that we have built a culture that has no patience for it.

At FOLA, we don't ask how long it will take. We ask what it needs right now.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 54

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-28

LinkedIn:

You can be grieving and not know it.

You can be grieving a relationship that ended five years ago. A childhood you never had. A career path you didn't choose. A version of yourself that died when you became a parent.

You can be grieving something that hasn't happened yet ? the loss of a parent who is still alive but aging, the end of a marriage that is still technically intact, the departure of children who haven't left home yet.

Anticipatory grief is real. And it is rarely named.

At FOLA, we help people name what they're grieving ? even when they don't have the words for it yet.

Because you cannot mourn what you cannot name.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 55

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-28

LinkedIn:

I have learned something from sitting with people in their grief.

The ones who heal are not the ones who feel less. They are the ones who learn to stay.

To stay with the discomfort. To stay with the sadness without needing to fix it. To stay with the part of themselves that is broken and not rush to repair.

This is counterintuitive. Everything in our culture tells you to move on, to get over it, to find the silver lining.

But healing doesn't happen on the other side of grief. It happens inside it.

At FOLA, we don't pull people out of their grief. We sit with them in it. And we teach them to sit with themselves.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 56

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes after healing.

You do the work. You process the trauma. You learn to set boundaries. You build a life that feels more like yours.

And then one day you look around and realise: the people who were supposed to be here for this version of you are not here.

Some left because your healing threatened their comfort. Some left because they couldn't keep up. Some were never capable of showing up the way you needed them to.

This is the grief of outgrowing your old life. It is real. It is valid. And nobody warns you about it.

At FOLA, we prepare people for this grief. Because healing is not just about what you gain. It is about what you lose.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 57

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29

LinkedIn:

Most people think grief is about the past.

It's not. Grief is about the future you thought you'd have.

The relationship you thought would work out. The child you thought would be healthy. The career you thought would fulfil you. The retirement you thought you'd enjoy together.

When you lose someone or something, you don't just lose the history. You lose the entire future that was attached to them.

This is why grief feels infinite. Because the future you lost was infinite.

At FOLA, we help people grieve not just what was, but what will never be.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 58

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-30

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing you can do with grief is compare it.

'Other people have it worse.' 'I shouldn't still be upset about this.' 'It's been long enough.'

These are not wisdom. They are avoidance dressed as perspective.

Grief does not respond to comparison. It does not care about your hierarchy of suffering. It only cares whether you are letting it move through you.

The moment you tell yourself your grief is not valid enough, you push it underground. And underground, grief grows roots.

At FOLA, we don't rank pain. We make space for all of it.

Because the only grief that heals is the grief that is allowed to be exactly what it is.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 59

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-30

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a parent.

Not the obvious grief ? the sleep deprivation, the loss of freedom, the body that doesn't look the same.

The grief of realising you cannot protect your child from everything.

The grief of seeing your own childhood wounds reflected in your parenting.

The grief of knowing that no matter how hard you try, you will pass some of your pain to them.

This grief is rarely spoken. Because admitting it feels like failure. Like you're not grateful enough for what you have.

But this grief is not ingratitude. It is love, mourning its own limits.

At FOLA, we make space for parental grief. The kind that has no ceremony and no witness.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 60

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-01

LinkedIn:

I have watched couples grieve the same loss differently.

A miscarriage. A job loss. A child leaving home.

One partner needs to talk about it. The other needs to be silent about it. One needs to feel the sadness fully. The other needs to stay busy to cope.

And because they grieve differently, each one thinks the other doesn't care.

This is one of the most common fractures in relationships ? not a lack of love, but a mismatch in grief styles.

The LoveBETTER Assessment flags these differences. Not to pathologise them. To help you understand that your partner's way of grieving is not a rejection of yours.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 61

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-01

LinkedIn:

You have been taught that healing is a straight line.

You do the work. You feel better. You move on. If you feel worse again, you must have done something wrong.

This is a lie.

Healing is a spiral. You will circle back to the same wounds ? but each time, you will be a slightly different version of yourself. Each time, you will see something you didn't see before. Each time, you will have more capacity to hold what you couldn't hold before.

The spiral is not failure. It is depth.

At FOLA, we don't promise a straight line. We promise a practice. A way of returning to yourself, over and over, with increasing compassion.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 62

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-02

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a Black professional in South Africa.

The grief of being the first in your family to have certain opportunities. The grief of carrying the expectations of an entire community. The grief of succeeding in spaces where your parents could not even enter.

This grief is rarely named. Because it feels ungrateful. How can you mourn success?

But success and grief are not opposites. You can be grateful for what you've built and still grieve what it cost you. The distance from your family. The loneliness of being the only one. The pressure of representing more than yourself.

At FOLA, we make space for this grief. The grief of the first generation. The grief of the pioneer.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 63

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-02

LinkedIn:

The most common form of unassisted mourning in our culture is the grief of the caregiver.

The parent who never stops parenting. The adult child caring for aging parents. The partner who holds the emotional weight of the relationship.

You have been so busy taking care of everyone else that you never had time to grieve what this has cost you.

The years you lost. The parts of yourself you put aside. The life you might have lived if you hadn't been needed so much.

This grief is not selfish. It is honest.

At FOLA, we help caregivers grieve. Because you cannot pour from an empty well. And you cannot heal what you refuse to admit you've lost.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 64

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-03

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with leaving a religion.

Or a political identity. Or a family system. Or any structure that gave your life meaning and belonging.

You left because it no longer fit. Because you could no longer believe what you were asked to believe. Because the cost of staying was higher than the cost of leaving.

But leaving doesn't mean you're not grieving. You are grieving the community you lost. The

certainty you once had. The version of yourself that belonged somewhere without question.

This grief is real. And it is rarely honoured.

At FOLA, we honour it. Because leaving a system that shaped you is not a betrayal. It is an evolution. And evolution comes with loss.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 65

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-03

LinkedIn:

I want to tell you something about grief that nobody told me.

It doesn't end.

Not because you're doing it wrong. Not because you're weak. Because grief is not a process with a finish line. It is a permanent reorganisation of your relationship with what you've lost.

You will learn to carry it differently. You will find moments when it doesn't hurt. You will build a life that includes the loss rather than being defined by it.

But it doesn't end. And that is not failure. That is love, continuing in a different form.

At FOLA, we don't promise to end your grief. We promise to help you carry it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 66

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-04

LinkedIn:

Most people think therapy is about understanding your past.

It's not. It's about freeing your present from the grip of a past that is no longer happening.

You don't need to understand every detail of why you are the way you are. You need to feel the feelings you never got to feel. You need to grieve what you never got to grieve. You need to let your nervous system know that the danger is over.

Understanding is helpful. But it is not healing.

Healing is the body finally releasing what it has been holding for decades.

At FOLA, we don't just talk about the past. We help you complete the unfinished business of it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 67

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-04

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being the one who always holds it together.

The strong one. The reliable one. The one everyone turns to when things fall apart.

You have been so busy being strong for everyone else that you never learned how to fall apart yourself.

And now you don't know how. The tears won't come. The words won't form. Your body has forgotten how to release because it has been holding for so long.

This is not strength. This is grief that has never been given permission to exist.

At FOLA, we give it permission. We create a container where you don't have to be strong.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 68

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-05

LinkedIn:

The most overlooked grief in relationships is the grief of what never was.

The proposal that never came. The apology that was never offered. The conversation that was never had. The version of your partner that existed before the resentment set in.

You are not just grieving what you lost. You are grieving what you never had.

And this grief is harder to name because there is no clear event to point to. No funeral. No breakup. No single moment when it ended.

It just never began.

This is the quietest grief. And it deserves to be mourned.

At FOLA, we help you name what you never had. So you can finally stop waiting for it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 69

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-05

LinkedIn:

You can be grieving and still functioning.

In fact, most high-functioning people are grieving. They just have a very sophisticated system for hiding it from themselves.

The promotions. The side projects. The gym routine. The perfectly curated life.

None of it is fake. But all of it can be a way of staying one step ahead of the sadness that lives underneath.

Functioning is not the same as healing. You can be successful and still be carrying grief you've never touched.

At FOLA, we help high-functioning people stop running. Not because running is bad. Because you deserve to rest.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 70

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being the one who always forgives.

The one who smooths things over. The one who apologises first. The one who absorbs the tension so everyone else can be comfortable.

You have been so busy keeping the peace that you never learned how to make peace with your own pain.

This is not generosity. This is grief that has learned to disguise itself as accommodation.

At FOLA, we help you stop being the one who always forgives ? and start being the one who is honest about what you feel.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 71

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

The LoveBETTER Assessment measures something most people don't think to measure: your relationship with grief.

Not whether you've experienced loss. But whether you have the tools to mourn. Whether you have a container for sadness. Whether you know how to sit with pain without needing to fix it immediately.

Because the couples who heal are not the ones who avoid grief. They are the ones who have learned to meet it together.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 72

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

You have been taught that anger and grief are separate.

They are not. Anger is often grief's bodyguard. It shows up to protect the sadness underneath. It is easier to be angry than to be vulnerable. Anger gives you energy. Grief takes it away.

But if you only express the anger and never touch the grief underneath, you will stay stuck in a cycle of rage that never resolves.

At FOLA, we help you get past the bodyguard. Not to eliminate your anger. To find out who it is protecting.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 73

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a person who has been abandoned.

The grief of knowing that someone chose to leave. The grief of the questions you will never get answers to. The grief of the part of you that still waits for them to come back.

Abandonment doesn't just hurt. It teaches your nervous system that people leave. And that lesson doesn't unlearn itself just because someone new shows up.

At FOLA, we work with abandonment grief. Not to help you trust again immediately. To help your nervous system feel safe enough to eventually consider it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 74

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a man in this culture.

The grief of never having been taught how to feel. Of being told that strength means silence. Of carrying the weight of your family's expectations without ever being asked how you're doing.

Men are not allowed to grieve openly. So their grief becomes anger. Becomes withdrawal. Becomes workaholism. Becomes the heart attack at 55 that nobody saw coming.

This is unassisted mourning at a cultural scale.

At FOLA, we create space for men to grieve. Not to fix them. To let them finally feel what they've been carrying alone.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 75

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

The LoveBETTER Assessment asks a question most couples never answer honestly: 'What are you grieving in this relationship?'

Most people say 'nothing.' Because they think grief means death. They don't realise that grief is also the silence at dinner. The joke you stopped telling because they didn't laugh. The part of yourself you put away because it didn't fit the relationship.

Every relationship has grief. The question is whether you're carrying it together or alone.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 76

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-07

LinkedIn:

You can be grieving a person who is still alive.

The parent who was never capable of loving you the way you needed. The partner who is physically present but emotionally unavailable. The friend who changed after success.

This grief is confusing because there is no clear loss. No funeral. No closure. Just the ongoing ache of being in relationship with someone who cannot meet you where you are.

This is disenfranchised grief ? grief that has no social recognition. And it is one of the most common reasons people end up in my practice.

At FOLA, we validate this grief. Because you don't need someone to die for your loss to be real.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 77

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-07

LinkedIn:

Most people don't know that grief has a physiological component.

When you experience a significant loss, your brain literally rewires. The neural pathways that were connected to the person or thing you lost don't know what to do with themselves. They keep firing, looking for a connection that no longer exists.

This is why grief is exhausting. It's not just emotional. It's neurological. Your brain is doing the equivalent of running a search algorithm that keeps returning 'not found.'

At FOLA, we understand the neuroscience of grief. We don't just talk about it. We work with the nervous system to help it integrate what has been lost.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 78

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-08

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a mother.

The grief of losing your body to another human. The grief of never being alone again. The grief of watching your child struggle and knowing you cannot fix it. The grief of the career you paused, the dreams you deferred, the version of yourself that existed before the first positive test.

This grief is not ingratitude. It is the shadow side of love. And it is rarely spoken because mothers are supposed to be grateful.

At FOLA, we make space for maternal grief. The kind that has no language and no witness.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 79

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-08

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it becomes a family inheritance.

Your parents didn't know how to grieve. So they passed it to you ? not through words, but through the atmosphere of the home you grew up in. The sadness that was never named. The anger that stood in for pain. The silence around anything that mattered.

And now you are carrying grief that isn't even yours. Grief that belongs to your mother. Your father. Your grandmother who lost children she never spoke about.

This is intergenerational grief. And it doesn't heal until someone in the lineage stops and feels it.

At FOLA, we help you feel what your ancestors could not. So the inheritance stops here.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 80

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-09

LinkedIn:

I have learned that grief and gratitude are not opposites.

They are companions.

You can grieve what you lost and be grateful for what you had. You can grieve the relationship that ended and be grateful for what it taught you. You can grieve the childhood you didn't have and be grateful for the adult you became.

The problem is not that you feel both. The problem is that our culture tells you to choose one.

At FOLA, we don't ask you to choose. We help you hold both.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 81

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-09

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a healer.

The grief of holding other people's pain while your own goes unattended. The grief of knowing exactly what someone needs and not being able to give it to yourself. The grief of being the one everyone turns to ? and having no one to turn to.

This is the grief of the practitioner. The therapist. The pastor. The healer who heals

everyone except themselves.

At FOLA, we see you. We know what this costs. And we are building a community where healers can also be healed.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 82

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-10

LinkedIn:

The LoveBETTER Assessment measures something most relationship tools miss: grief compatibility.

Not whether you've both experienced loss. But whether your grief styles are compatible.

One partner needs to talk. The other needs to be alone. One needs ritual. The other needs distraction. Neither is wrong. But if you don't understand each other's grief language, you will keep hurting each other when you're both already hurting.

The assessment flags these differences. Not to create conflict. To create understanding.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 83

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-10

LinkedIn:

You have been taught that time heals all wounds.

This is not true.

Time does not heal wounds. Time just passes. What heals wounds is what you do with the time ? the mourning, the feeling, the integration, the support, the practices that allow your nervous system to finally register that the danger is over.

Without those things, time doesn't heal. It just buries. And buried wounds don't disappear. They fester.

At FOLA, we don't rely on time. We rely on practice. On presence. On the slow, intentional work of meeting grief where it lives.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 84

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-11

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being an entrepreneur.

The grief of carrying the full weight of your vision alone. The grief of the relationships that suffered because you were building. The grief of the stability you gave up. The grief of watching friends advance in conventional careers while you're still in the uncertainty phase.

This grief is rarely named because entrepreneurs are supposed to be optimistic. But optimism and grief are not mutually exclusive. You can believe in what you're building and still grieve what it costs.

At FOLA, we make space for entrepreneurial grief. The kind that has no business school curriculum.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 85

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-11

LinkedIn:

The most overlooked form of grief in our culture is the grief of the child who had to grow up too fast.

The eldest daughter. The child of immigrants. The one who became the parent to their own parents. The one who learned to take care of everyone else before they learned to take care of themselves.

You never got to be a child. And now you don't know how to rest, how to ask for help, how to let someone else carry the weight.

This is not a character flaw. It is a grief that has never been mourned.

At FOLA, we help you grieve the childhood you never had. So you can finally stop living like you're still responsible for everyone.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 86

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-12

LinkedIn:

I want to tell you something about grief that might change how you see it.

Grief is not the opposite of joy. It is the price of love.

The more you loved, the more you will grieve. The deeper the attachment, the deeper the loss. This is not a flaw in the design. It is the design.

If you are grieving deeply, it means you loved deeply. And that is not something to recover from. It is something to honour.

At FOLA, we don't try to reduce your grief. We help you honour what it represents.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 87

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-12

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a Black woman in South Africa.

The grief of carrying the strength narrative. Of being expected to hold everything

together. Of being the backbone of the family, the community, the workplace ? and never being asked who holds you.

The grief of being seen as strong rather than seen as human.

This grief is real. It is heavy. And it is rarely given space.

At FOLA, we create space for Black women to not be strong. To fall apart. To be held.

Because strength is not the absence of grief. It is the courage to let it be witnessed.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 88

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-13

LinkedIn:

Most people think the goal of therapy is to feel better.

It's not. The goal is to feel more.

To feel the grief you've been avoiding. To feel the anger you've been suppressing. To feel the longing you've been numbing. To feel the joy you've been distrusting.

Healing is not about reducing your emotional range. It is about expanding it. So that you can feel the full spectrum of being alive ? including the parts that hurt.

At FOLA, we don't numb. We expand.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 89

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-13

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a father.

The grief of not knowing how to be present because your own father wasn't. The grief of providing materially but not emotionally. The grief of realising too late that your children needed you, not your paycheck.

The grief of the cycle you swore you'd break ? and then caught yourself repeating.

This grief is rarely spoken because fathers are supposed to have it together. But the silence is the problem.

At FOLA, we help fathers grieve. So they can show up differently for the next generation.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 90

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-14

LinkedIn:

The LoveBETTER Assessment includes something most assessments don't: a grief inventory.

Not because grief is a disorder. Because unprocessed grief is the most common barrier to

intimacy.

You cannot be fully present in a relationship when part of you is still living in a loss you never mourned. You cannot trust fully when grief has taught you that everything leaves.

The grief inventory doesn't pathologise your loss. It maps it. So you can see where grief is still running the show.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 91

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-14

LinkedIn:

You can be grieving and not know what you're grieving.

You just know something is off. You feel heavy. You cry at things that shouldn't make you cry. You have less patience than usual. You're tired in a way that sleep doesn't fix.

This is grief without an object ? sadness that has no clear target because it's accumulated from many small losses over time.

The job that didn't work out. The friendship that faded. The dream you quietly abandoned. The version of yourself you thought you'd be by now.

None of these qualify as a major loss on their own. But together, they form a grief that deserves attention.

At FOLA, we help you trace the sadness back to its sources. So you can finally mourn what you've been carrying.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 92

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-15

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a survivor.

Of abuse. Of violence. Of a childhood that should have been different. Of a system that was never designed to protect you.

You survived. You are here. You built a life. But the grief of what happened ? and what should have happened instead ? is still there.

Survival is not the same as healing. You can survive and still be carrying grief you've never touched.

At FOLA, we work with survivors. Not to tell you that you're strong. To help you grieve what you should never have had to endure.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 93

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-15

LinkedIn:

The most common question I get about grief is: 'When will I stop feeling this way?'

The answer is: you won't. But it will change shape.

In the beginning, grief is a boulder. It sits on your chest and you cannot breathe around it. Then it becomes a stone in your pocket ? you know it's there, but you can function. Then it becomes a scar ? a permanent mark that no longer hurts to touch.

It doesn't disappear. It integrates. It becomes part of the landscape of who you are.

At FOLA, we don't promise to remove the boulder. We help you learn to carry it. And eventually, to let it become part of the ground you walk on.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 94

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-16

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a woman in a patriarchal world.

The grief of being paid less for the same work. Of being interrupted in meetings. Of being judged for your appearance rather than your ideas. Of being afraid to walk alone at night. Of the cumulative weight of a thousand small indignities that you're told not to make a big deal about.

This grief is not paranoia. It is the body's honest response to living in a system that was not built for you.

At FOLA, we validate this grief. Because you cannot heal what you are not allowed to name.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 95

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-16

LinkedIn:

I have noticed something about the couples who heal fastest.

They are not the ones with the least problems. They are the ones who learn to grieve together.

When one partner loses a parent, the other doesn't try to fix it. They sit in the grief. When one partner is diagnosed with something serious, the other doesn't rush to solutions. They stay in the uncertainty.

This is the deepest form of intimacy ? not solving each other's pain, but witnessing it.

The LoveBETTER Assessment helps couples identify where they're avoiding grief together. So they can learn to meet each other in the hard places.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_gr

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Post 96

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-17

LinkedIn:

You have been taught that crying is weakness.

Let me correct that.

Crying is a physiological release. When you cry, your body is literally flushing out stress hormones. Tears contain cortisol. Crying is your nervous system's way of regulating itself.

The people who cannot cry are not strong. They are holding. And holding takes energy that could be used for living.

At FOLA, we don't see tears as weakness. We see them as the body's intelligence, finally doing what it was designed to do.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 97

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-17

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a creative person.

The grief of having ideas that never make it into the world. Of watching others succeed at what you're afraid to start. Of the gap between what you envision and what you can execute. Of the years you spent not making art because you didn't think you were good enough.

This grief is real. And it is rarely honoured because creativity is supposed to be joyful.

But creativity is also loss. Every choice to make one thing is a choice not to make a hundred others. Every finished piece is the death of the infinite possibilities that existed before you committed.

At FOLA, we honour creative grief. The grief of choosing. The grief of finishing. The grief of putting your work into a world that may not receive it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 98

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-18

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it becomes a lens.

When you haven't mourned your losses, you see the world through grief. Every interaction is filtered through the pain you're carrying. Every slight feels like confirmation that the world is unsafe. Every disappointment is evidence that nothing works out.

This is not pessimism. This is unprocessed grief colouring your perception.

At FOLA, we help you clear the lens. Not by pretending the pain isn't there. By mourning it so thoroughly that it no longer distorts everything else.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 99

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-18

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a person who has done a lot of therapy.

The grief of knowing yourself deeply and still struggling. Of having the language for your patterns and still repeating them. Of understanding your trauma intellectually and still feeling it in your body.

This grief is confusing because you've done the work. You should be better by now. But healing is not linear. And knowing is not the same as being free.

At FOLA, we work with people who have done years of therapy and still feel stuck. Not because the therapy was wrong. Because some grief can only be healed in the body, not in the mind.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 100

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-19

LinkedIn:

The LoveBETTER Assessment ends with a question most assessments don't ask: 'What are you ready to grieve?'

Because the willingness to grieve is the willingness to heal. The couples who are willing to sit with what they've lost ? the dreams, the trust, the version of each other that existed before the pain ? are the couples who actually recover.

The ones who refuse to grieve are the ones who stay stuck.

Grief is not the enemy of love. It is the doorway back to it.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_grief

Post 101

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-19

LinkedIn:

You have been taught that healing means letting go.

Let me offer a different frame: healing means integrating.

You don't let go of the person you lost. You find a way to carry them that doesn't break you. You don't let go of the childhood you deserved. You find a way to give it to yourself now. You don't let go of the relationship that ended. You find a way to honour what it taught you.

Letting go is not the goal. Integration is.

At FOLA, we don't ask you to let go. We help you integrate. So that what you've lost becomes part of the foundation, not the ceiling.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 102

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-20

LinkedIn:

There is a grief that comes with being a person who has been betrayed.

The grief of the trust you can never get back. The grief of the innocence you lost. The grief of knowing that from now on, part of you will always be watching for the exit.

Betrayal doesn't just hurt. It rewires your nervous system. It teaches your body that safety is an illusion. And that lesson doesn't unlearn itself just because you've forgiven.

At FOLA, we work with betrayal grief. Not to help you trust again immediately. To help your nervous system feel safe enough to eventually consider it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 103

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-20

LinkedIn:

I will leave you with this.

Grief is not a problem to be solved. It is a relationship to be maintained.

You don't get over significant loss. You learn to carry it. You learn to let it change you. You learn to build a life that includes the absence.

And you don't have to do it alone.

At FOLA, we companion people through grief. Not to fix it. To witness it. To make sure that when you mourn, you are not mourning alone.

If you are carrying something you haven't named, we are here.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 104

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-21

LinkedIn:

There is a particular loneliness that comes with healing when your partner refuses to change.

You are doing the work. Reading the books. Going to therapy. Learning to communicate differently. And every time you come home with something new, you hit the same wall.

They don't see it. They don't feel it. They don't think anything is wrong enough to

warrant this much effort.

And slowly, you start to wonder: is it worse to be alone in this relationship than it would be to be alone by yourself?

This is the grief of outgrowing someone while still loving them. The grief of knowing that your growth is creating distance, not closeness.

At FOLA, we work with people in this exact position. Not to tell you to leave. To help you see clearly enough to make a decision you can live with.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 105

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-21

LinkedIn:

You know the feeling. They're fine. They're nice. They show up. They don't cause drama.

But there's a part of you that doesn't respect them. A part that knows you're settling. A part that stays because leaving feels harder than staying ? and because you're not sure you deserve better.

This is not love. This is convenience dressed as commitment.

And the person you're hurting most is yourself. Because every day you stay in a relationship you don't fully respect, you are telling yourself that this is all you're worth.

The LoveBETTER Assessment has a way of surfacing this. Not to shame you. To show you what you already know but haven't admitted.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_ha rdtruths

Post 106

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-22

LinkedIn:

Most people don't stay in bad relationships because they love the person.

They stay because they're afraid of what they've never experienced. A life alone. A different kind of love. The unknown shape of a future that doesn't include this person.

Fear of the unfamiliar is one of the most powerful forces keeping people stuck. Your brain would rather stay in a known pain than risk an unknown one.

This is not weakness. This is survival wiring. Your nervous system is designed to prefer the familiar, even when the familiar is hurting you.

At FOLA, we help you separate fear from intuition. So you can tell the difference between 'I'm scared of change' and 'this isn't right for me.'

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 107

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-22

LinkedIn:

There is nothing more exhausting than loving someone who won't decide about you.

They're in. They're out. They need space. They miss you. They're not ready. They might be ready soon. They don't know what they want ? but they don't want to lose you either.

And you stay. Because the good moments are so good. Because when they show up, they show up fully. Because you keep hoping that this time, they'll finally choose.

But here's what I know: an undecided lover has already decided. They've decided that their comfort is more important than your clarity.

At FOLA, we help people stop waiting for someone else to make a decision about their life.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 108

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-23

LinkedIn:

You are trying to build something better. A healthier relationship. A stronger connection. A new way of communicating.

And every time you take a step forward, your partner quits.

They quit the conversation. They quit the exercise. They quit the commitment they made last week. They quit on the version of themselves they promised to become.

And slowly, your hope erodes. Not because you stopped believing in the relationship. Because you got tired of being the only one carrying it.

This is the grief of being the only builder in a relationship where the other person keeps walking away from the construction site.

At FOLA, we help you see this pattern clearly. So you can stop carrying what was never meant to be yours alone.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 109

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-23

LinkedIn:

You are dying silently in a relationship that looks fine from the outside.

You still show up. You still do the things. You still say 'I love you' because it's what you're supposed to say. But inside, you are hollow. You are carrying the weight of everything that isn't working, and you are carrying it alone.

Nobody knows because you've gotten very good at performing okayness.

This is the most dangerous kind of relationship suffering ? the kind that has no witness. Because without a witness, there is no intervention. There is no one to say 'you don't

have to live like this.'

The LoveBETTER Assessment is designed to surface what you've been carrying alone. Not to diagnose. To give you permission to stop pretending.

https://lovebetter.co.za/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=lovebetter_ha
rdtruths

Post 110

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-24

LinkedIn:

The most common couple I meet is not the one that's falling apart.

It's the one that's slowly drifting apart while both people hope it will fix itself.

They don't fight. They don't yell. They just... coexist. They hope that time will heal the distance. They hope that things will get better when the kids are older, when the job settles down, when they have more money, when the season changes.

But hope without action is just waiting. And waiting is a decision.

At FOLA, we don't do hope. We do practice. We do the uncomfortable conversations. We do the exercises that feel awkward. We do the work that most couples avoid until it's too late.

Because hope is not a strategy. Practice is.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 111

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-24

LinkedIn:

You started therapy. You started reading. You started trying to communicate differently.

And your partner said: 'You think you're so much better than me now.'

This is a specific kind of pain ? when your growth is met with resentment instead of relief. When the person who should be your biggest supporter treats your healing as a threat.

Some partners want you to stay small because your growth makes them confront their own stagnation.

At FOLA, we help you navigate this. Not by shrinking. By learning how to grow without making your partner feel left behind ? and recognising when that's not your responsibility.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 112

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-25

LinkedIn:

You are always the one who starts the conversation.

The one who says 'we need to talk.' The one who books the therapy. The one who buys the book. The one who suggests the date night. The one who apologises first.

And you are tired.

Not because the effort is too much. Because you are the only one making it.

This is the grief of being the initiator in a relationship where the other person is content to let you carry the entire emotional load.

At FOLA, we help couples redistribute this weight. Because a relationship where one person does all the emotional labour is not a partnership. It's a performance.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 113

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-25

LinkedIn:

You are not in love with who they are. You are in love with who they could be.

If they just went to therapy. If they just stopped drinking. If they just communicated more. If they just dealt with their childhood wounds. If they just tried as hard as you are trying.

You are dating their potential. And potential is not a person. It is a fantasy.

At some point, you have to ask yourself: if they never change ? if this is who they are right now, today, forever ? would you still choose this?

If the answer is no, you are not in a relationship. You are in a waiting room.

At FOLA, we help you stop waiting and start choosing.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 114

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-26

LinkedIn:

You made a mistake. Years ago. You told them about it in confidence. You thought it was behind you.

But every time there's an argument, they bring it up. Every time they feel insecure, they use it as evidence. Every time you try to grow, they hold your past over your head.

This is not accountability. This is a weapon.

A partner who keeps your past alive is not interested in your growth. They are interested in keeping you small enough to control.

At FOLA, we help couples distinguish between genuine accountability and weaponised history. Because a relationship cannot heal if one person keeps reopening the same wound.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 115

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-26

LinkedIn:

You see things they don't see.

You notice the pattern. You understand why you fight about the same thing. You can trace the argument back to the childhood wound it's touching. You have the language for what's happening between you.

And they don't.

This is a specific kind of loneliness ? being the more emotionally aware person in a relationship. You can see the solution, but you cannot implement it alone. You need two people to heal a relationship, and you are the only one who showed up with tools.

At FOLA, we work with people in this position. Not to make you smaller. To help you find ways to invite your partner into awareness without resenting them for not being there yet.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 116

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-27

LinkedIn:

You have outgrown this relationship.

You know it. You feel it every day. The conversations feel smaller. The connection feels thinner. The future you once imagined together no longer fits.

But you can't leave. Because of the children. Because of the finances. Because of what people will think. Because you still love them even though you're not in love with them. Because leaving would mean admitting that you wasted years.

This is the grief of outgrowing someone without a clean exit. The grief of knowing what you need to do and not being able to do it.

At FOLA, we don't tell you what to do. We help you sit with the truth until you can no longer avoid acting on it.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 117

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-27

LinkedIn:

You notice the pattern.

When you are fully present, they are distant. When you pull away, they chase. When you stop trying, they suddenly start. When you threaten to leave, they promise to change.

And then, as soon as you're back, they go back to the same behaviour.

This is not love. This is a response to the fear of loss. They don't want you. They don't want to lose you. Those are different things.

At FOLA, we help you see this pattern for what it is. So you can stop playing the game and start asking for what you actually need.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 118

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-28

LinkedIn:

You did the work. You healed. You grew. You became a version of yourself that you actually like.

And now your relationship doesn't fit anymore.

This is one of the cruelest ironies of healing. You do everything right. You face your demons. You learn to communicate. You set boundaries. You stop people-pleasing. You become the partner you always wanted to be.

And the relationship that worked for the old you cannot hold the new you.

This is not failure. This is evolution. But it hurts anyway.

At FOLA, we help people navigate the grief of outgrowing a relationship that was never designed for who you are becoming.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 119

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-28

LinkedIn:

You are 'too sensitive.' You are 'overreacting.' You are 'making a big deal out of nothing.'

Every time you express a feeling, they tell you that your feeling is wrong. Not that they disagree with your interpretation. That your feeling itself is invalid.

This is gaslighting. And over time, it erodes your ability to trust your own perception.

You start to wonder: am I too much? Am I the problem? Maybe I am overreacting.

You are not. You are in a relationship with someone who cannot hold your emotional reality.

At FOLA, we help you reclaim your perception. Because your feelings are not up for debate.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 120

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-29

LinkedIn:

You are always the bigger person.

The one who apologises even when it wasn't your fault. The one who extends grace. The one who understands that they're struggling and makes space for it. The one who swallows your own hurt so the peace can be kept.

And you are exhausted.

Being the bigger person is not a virtue when it costs you your own wellbeing. At some point, being the bigger person is just another word for self-abandonment.

At FOLA, we help you stop being the bigger person and start being the person who tells the truth about what you need.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 121

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-29

LinkedIn:

They say the right things.

'I'll do better.' 'I hear you.' 'I know I need to work on this.' 'Give me another chance.'

And you believe them. Because you want to believe them. Because the alternative ? that they are not going to change ? is too painful to accept.

But words without action are not change. They are pacification. They are a way to keep you in the relationship without actually doing the work.

At FOLA, we help you stop measuring love by promises and start measuring it by practice.

Because if their behaviour hasn't changed, their words mean nothing.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 122

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-30

LinkedIn:

You know before they know.

You feel the distance before they notice it. You see the signs before they register. You know it's ending long before the conversation happens.

And you carry that knowledge alone. You watch them go about their day, acting like everything is fine, while you are already grieving the end of something they don't even know is dying.

This is a specific kind of loneliness ? being the one who sees the truth before the other person is ready to see it.

At FOLA, we help you navigate this liminal space. The space between knowing and acting.

The space where grief lives before it has a name.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 123

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-30

LinkedIn:

You were not always like this.

Before this relationship, you were louder. You laughed more. You had opinions. You took up space.

But somewhere along the way, you learned that taking up space was unsafe. That your opinions would be dismissed. That your laughter would be criticised. That the person who was supposed to love you actually preferred a smaller version of you.

And you shrank. Not because you wanted to. Because it was the only way to keep the peace.

At FOLA, we help you take up space again. Not by leaving. By remembering who you were before you learned to be small.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 124

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-31

LinkedIn:

You have a partner who cannot tolerate peace.

When things are calm, they create conflict. When things are stable, they find a crisis. When there is no drama, they manufacture it.

You spend your life putting out fires they started. You are always in reaction mode. You cannot rest because the moment you do, something will explode.

This is not passion. This is chaos addiction. And it will burn you out.

At FOLA, we help people in relationships with chaos-addicted partners. Not to fix the partner. To help you stop being the firefighter in a house that someone keeps setting on fire.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 125

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-31

LinkedIn:

You tried everything.

Therapy. Books. Conversations. Space. Closeness. Compromise. Boundaries. Giving more. Giving less. Being patient. Being direct.

You tried everything. And nothing worked.

This is the grief of knowing that you did not fail the relationship. You showed up. You

did the work. You gave it everything you had.

And it still wasn't enough. Not because you weren't enough. Because a relationship cannot be carried by one person.

At FOLA, we help you make peace with having tried everything. So you can let go without guilt.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 126

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-01

LinkedIn:

You can feel it when they're upset.

The silence. The coldness. The withdrawal of affection. The way they look through you instead of at you.

They don't say what's wrong. They make you guess. And when you ask, they say 'nothing' in a tone that means everything.

This is emotional withholding. And it is a form of control.

It teaches you to walk on eggshells. To monitor their mood. To apologise for things you didn't do just to bring them back.

At FOLA, we help you name this pattern. Because you cannot address what you cannot name.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 127

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-01

LinkedIn:

You stayed too long.

You know this now. Looking back, you can see the moment you should have left. The red flag you ignored. The boundary you didn't set. The voice you silenced.

And now you are grieving not just the relationship, but the time you will never get back.

This grief is real. And it is heavy. But here is what I want you to know: you stayed because you believed in love. You stayed because you hoped. You stayed because leaving felt like giving up.

That is not weakness. That is a heart that refuses to quit.

At FOLA, we help you make peace with the time you spent. Not as wasted years. As the tuition you paid to learn what you will never accept again.

Book a discovery call: <https://calendly.com/folasessions/discovery-call>

Post 128

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-15

LinkedIn:

Seven out of ten Black boys in South Africa are raised by single mothers.

That number is not a social statistic. It is a clinical starting point.

In fifteen-plus years of session work, the single most consistent thread I encounter in Black men ? across income brackets, across cities, across industries ? is not depression, not anxiety, not imposter syndrome.

It is the father wound.

Abandonment is the correct word for it. Not absent. Not busy. Not trying his best.

When a man can no longer provide ? or never learned to ? he does not just feel like he has failed at a task. He feels like he has failed at being a person.

Age Regression Therapy, as I apply it, does not begin with the presenting wound. It begins earlier ? with the inner child who learned what it meant to be a boy in the specific environment he grew up in.

Inner child healing is not metaphor. It is neurological.

This is why talking about it is insufficient.

If you work with Black men ? clinically, in HR, as a coach, as a mentor ? the most important thing I can tell you this Men's Mental Health Month is this:

The anger is not the problem. The silence is not strength. And the man sitting across from you who seems fine is probably not fine.

He is winging it. In a life that requires tools he was never given.

The work begins there.

? Hakeem Lesolang

Trauma & Hypnotherapy Practitioner | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

You learned to do it before you knew you were learning.

One face for the house. One face for outside.

At home, you kept quiet. Not because you didn't have opinions ? you had plenty. But you'd learned, meal by meal, argument by argument, that opinions were a luxury that got taken from you fast.

So you folded them away.

Outside, with your boys, you became someone else. Louder. More certain. Someone who took up space without asking.

What none of us understood is that we were selecting each other by what we'd survived. Trauma bonding in school uniforms.

You go through your twenties doing the same thing. Two masks. The one you wear at work.

The one you wear at home. Neither of them fully you.

And somewhere around 35, 40, you start to feel the weight of them. Not the masks. The weight of never taking them off.

Men don't talk. That's what we were told.

The problem is ? they do. Just not about the right things.

At FOLA, we don't just talk about the masks. We go back to where you first put them on. And we help you find out who you are without them.

That man is still in there.

? fola.co.za

Post 129

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18

LinkedIn:

A man came to a session recently with one presenting problem: overthinking.

He'd analyzed it well. Could describe the pattern, identify the triggers, even predict when it would happen. He had the vocabulary. He had the self-awareness.

He still couldn't stop.

This is the gap between insight and integration. And it is where most mental health interventions leave Black men.

When I encounter a man who overthinks, what I'm looking at is not a cognitive problem. I'm looking at a nervous system that learned, at some point in childhood, that it was not safe to trust its own instincts.

That is not a bad strategy. For a child in an unpredictable environment, it is a brilliant one.

The problem is the nervous system doesn't automatically retire strategies just because the original threat is gone.

The masculine ideal ? particularly in Black South African communities ? trains boys to interpret this as weakness. As something to be corrected through discipline or toughened out of.

It cannot be toughened out. It can only be healed.

And healing, in clinical terms, means reaching the moment the programme was written and writing a different one. At the level of the body and the nervous system ? where the original code lives.

This is the work I do.

If you are a Black man reading this who has never had access to this kind of work ? not because you didn't want it, but because no one ever told you it existed ? I want you to know:

You are not behind. You are not broken. You were never given the map.

We have it.

? Hakeem Lesolang

Trauma & Hypnotherapy Practitioner | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

There's a story I tell in the room.

A young man. Good upbringing ? not perfect, but solid. He gets an opportunity too good to pass up. Scholarship. Education. A way out. He takes it.

On the day he graduates, war breaks out. He gets stationed. And from the moment the plane lands, it's war.

He fights. He loses people. He does things he can't undo.

Eventually, the war pauses. Not ends ? pauses. He goes home.

And everyone treats him like the person who left.

So he performs it. He overworks. He drinks to quiet the noise. His relationships are on-and-off. Not because he's a bad man. Because he's a man running from a war that followed him home and nobody named it.

Now. I want you to take the soldier out of the story. Take the battlefield out.

Look at the boy who grew up watching his parents fight. The man who buried his father before he could say what needed saying. The one who built a business from nothing, hit walls he didn't understand, and found himself drinking alone at 10pm wondering why nothing felt like it was supposed to.

What's the difference between his story and the soldier's?

The body doesn't distinguish. Your nervous system doesn't ask whether the wound had a name. It just keeps the score.

PTSD is PTSD. Big T, small T. War, or the slow erosion of a boyhood that was never quite safe.

The question is not whether you've been through something. You have. We all have.

The question is: what are you going to do with a nervous system that was wired for survival in a world that's no longer asking you to survive ? just to live?

That's what the work is for.

? fola.co.za

Post 130

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-22

LinkedIn:

Men come to me because of their relationships.

They stay because of everything else.

A client ? a man who had built a significant logistics business from nothing, 28 trucks at his peak ? came to me not to become more successful. He came because something at the centre of his life had stopped making sense, and no amount of success was fixing it.

Six months into the work, his revenue doubled.

He'll tell you the session work was not about business. He'd be right. We worked on inner child healing. The father wound. His mother wound. Old romantic grief.

The business results were not the goal. They were the consequence.

This is the part of men's mental health that doesn't make it onto the campaign posters in June. The economic argument. The evidence that a man who stops running from his internal world becomes radically more capable in his external one.

Not because he works harder. Because he stops standing in his own way.

There is a version of yourself that has been waiting on the other side of this work. Not the aspirational, vision-board version. The functional one. The one who can sit in silence without it becoming unbearable. The one who can receive love without immediately looking for the exit.

That version exists. I have watched men become him.

The investment is ten sessions. The compound interest is a life.

If you are an employer, an HR director, a business leader in the South African corporate space ? I want to have a different conversation about your male employees. Not about EAP programmes. About actual transformation.

Let's talk.

? Hakeem Lesolang

Trauma & Hypnotherapy Practitioner | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

Seven out of ten Black boys in South Africa are raised without their fathers.

Seven out of ten.

That means if you're sitting with nine other Black men right now, only three of you had a father who stayed. Who was present. Who asked how school went without it being a performance of parenting.

I've sat across from enough men to know what that number feels like from the inside.

It feels like rage that has no return address. It feels like a hunger you keep feeding the wrong things to. It feels like not understanding why you're so good at being everything to everyone and still can't sit in a quiet room with yourself.

It is not weakness. It is what happens to a boy whose first lesson about himself was that he wasn't worth staying for.

The men who built themselves from that wound deserve more than admiration. They deserve actual help. Not coaching. Not a podcast. Not a meditation app. The kind of help that goes back to where the wound started and does something there.

At FOLA, that's exactly where we go first. First, to the boy who learned to survive without the thing he needed most.

Because the father wound is not a backstory. It is a blueprint. And you've been building from it your whole life.

We can give you a different blueprint.

? fola.co.za

Post 131

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

Every June, Men's Mental Health Month arrives and the conversation goes to the same four places:

Suicide statistics. The stigma of asking for help. Affirmations about strength and vulnerability. A crisis line number at the bottom.

And men, particularly Black men, scroll past all of it.

Not because they don't need help. Because the conversation is not for them. Not really.

Most of the mental health framework being promoted in June was not built with the Black male psyche in mind. It wasn't built for men who were raised in homes where emotional expression was punished, not rewarded. It wasn't built for men who carry not just personal trauma but generational trauma ? poverty, apartheid, displacement ? in their nervous systems, not as history but as biology.

The conversation about men's mental health in the South African context needs to be more specific. More culturally literate. And more honest about what actual healing requires.

It is not bravery to call a helpline.

It is systemic change. Clinical frameworks that meet Black men where they actually are. Practitioners who understand that the body keeps the score of things that happened before language. Spaces where a man can do real work without being made to feel like a cultural traitor for wanting to.

At FOLA, we are building that space. Not as an ideological project. As a clinical one.

If you work in mental health policy, corporate wellness, community development, or education ? and you want to have a serious conversation about what it would take to actually move the needle for Black men in this country ? I am available for that conversation.

The awareness month is useful. What happens in the other eleven months is where lives change.

? Hakeem Lesolang

Trauma & Hypnotherapy Practitioner | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

No one taught you how to process pain.

Not because you weren't paying attention. Because no one around you knew how either. Your father didn't know. His father didn't know.

What you got instead was a list of substitutes.

Sport. Drinking. Anger. Sex. Working until you couldn't feel anything. Staying so busy

that the thing you were running from never got a clear shot at you.

These are not character flaws. They are survival strategies. Perfectly designed for a boy who needed something to make the noise stop.

The problem is they don't stop working ? they just start costing more than you can pay.

The man who drinks doesn't want to drink. He wants to sleep without the thoughts that come when everything goes quiet. The man who lashes out isn't violent by nature. He's a person whose emotional toolkit ends at anger because anger was the only feeling that didn't get him punished.

If you knew the how, you would have done it already.

That's not a softening of the problem. It's a clinical fact.

The men I've worked with ? corporate executives, truck drivers, fathers, sons, men who look like they've got it figured out ? almost all of them were winging it. Functioning without tools in a life that required them at every turn.

You can get the tools. Not the motivational kind. The actual kind. The kind that rewire the nervous system, not just the narrative.

That's what healing actually is.

? fola.co.za

Post 132

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29

LinkedIn:

I was a suicidal teenager.

Raised in a village when everyone around me seemed to be growing up in suburbs. Not understanding why the world felt so uneven, so loud, so hard to navigate. I ended up in counselling rooms because I had no other language for what I was carrying.

The counselling didn't solve it. What it did was keep me alive long enough to find the work that eventually did.

I've spent the years since building what I wished had existed then. A practice that doesn't just witness pain. That does something about it.

I work with men specifically in a way that most practitioners do not. Not because I have something against women ? I work with them too, and I love that work. But because I have a particular interest in what happens to Black men who were raised without emotional tools, without adequate male presence, without the permission to be anything other than functional.

The men I work with are not weak. They are usually the strongest person in every room they walk into. That strength is the problem. Not because strength is wrong. Because strength has been the only mode available.

A man who can only be strong cannot rest. Cannot receive. Cannot let anyone close enough to matter. Cannot, ultimately, change.

The work I do ? Age Regression Therapy, hypnotherapy, neuroscience-informed CBT and NLP ?

is not soft. It is demanding. It asks a man to go back to places he has spent decades avoiding. And it asks him to stay long enough to do something there.

The men who complete the work do not just feel better.

They become different people. Not unrecognisable. More themselves. The version of them that was always there, behind the survival.

I still do this work on myself. Every time I encourage a man to go into the room, I know what it costs. And I know what it returns.

This month and every month ? if you are a man reading this who has been carrying something for a long time without moving it ? I want you to know it can be moved.

Not managed. Moved.

? Hakeem Lesolang

Trauma & Hypnotherapy Practitioner | FOLA Polyclinics

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Direct message to begin.

Facebook:

Talk therapy, as a Black person, is a complicated thing.

We have a history of DMs ? deep, meaningful conversations. We know how to talk around what hurts. We know how to name the problem so well that it feels like we've moved it.

But naming is not the same as healing.

If you've sat in a therapist's chair and left feeling heard but unchanged, it's not because you weren't ready. It's because most talk therapy treats the expression of the wound. Not the wound.

FOLA is not a therapy practice in the traditional sense. It is a transformation practice. We use hypnotherapy, neuroscience, NLP, and CBT ? not as tools in a kit, but as an integrated framework that goes where the conversation alone cannot go. Back into the body. Back into the nervous system. Back into the moment the wound was first made.

The goal is not management.

Not managed. Not coped with. Not better at living with the weight of it.

Healed.

Men in particular have been sold a version of mental health that asks them to talk about their pain without doing anything about it. We are asking something different. We are asking you to actually change.

That is a harder invitation to accept. But it is the only one that gets you to the other side.

We're here when you're ready.

? fola.co.za | DM us to book a discovery call.

Post 133

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-09

LinkedIn:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39.

At 9, silence kept you safe. At 39, silence is starving your marriage.

At 9, anger got you left alone. At 39, anger is the only language your nervous system speaks.

At 9, you learned to disappear. At 39, you're wondering why nobody sees you.

The strategy that kept you alive as a child is now the strategy that's keeping you stuck as a man. And the tragedy is ? you're still proud of it. You call it strength. You call it survival. You call it 'just how I am.'

But here's what nobody told you: the same walls that kept the monsters out are now keeping the love out.

This is what we work on at FOLA. Not coping. Not managing. Not surviving. We work on unlearning the strategies that outlived their purpose.

Because the boy who needed those walls is gone. The man inside them doesn't have to stay.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39. Silence kept you safe then. It's starving your relationships now. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 134

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-10

LinkedIn:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell.

No child wakes up angry. They wake up hungry, tired, scared, or unseen. And when nobody answers, the need learns to scream.

By the time you're a man, the screaming doesn't sound like a need anymore. It sounds like personality. It sounds like 'that's just how I am.'

But here's the clinical truth: anger is always a secondary emotion. Underneath it is fear, shame, grief, or helplessness. Always.

You don't need anger management. You need to find out what your anger is protecting.

At FOLA, we don't teach you to suppress the fire. We teach you what's burning underneath it.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
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Facebook:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell. Anger is always

secondary. Underneath it is something you were never taught to name. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 135

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-11

LinkedIn:

The quiet child was not fine.

He was not peaceful. He was not mature. He was not 'wise beyond his years.'

He was surviving.

He learned that his needs were a burden. That his voice was an inconvenience. That the safest thing he could be was invisible.

And now he's a man who can't ask for help. A man who disappears when things get hard. A man who is praised for being 'chill' while quietly drowning.

The quiet child was not fine. He was just quiet.

And quiet is not the same as okay.

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Facebook:

The quiet child was not fine. He was surviving. Quiet is not the same as okay. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 136

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-12

LinkedIn:

You learned love was performance.

If you were good enough, you'd be loved. If you achieved enough, you'd be seen. If you made no mistakes, you'd be safe.

So you performed. You performed in school. You performed at work. You performed in relationships. You became a master of doing the right thing ? while having no idea how to actually be with someone.

Because performance is not presence. Achievement is not intimacy. And being loved for what you do is not the same as being loved for who you are.

The tragedy is: you're still performing. And you're exhausted.

At FOLA, we help men unlearn the performance and find the person underneath.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

You learned love was performance. Achieve enough, be good enough, make no mistakes ? and maybe you'd be loved. But performance is not presence. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Polyclinics

Post 137

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-13

LinkedIn:

The good child wound.

You were the easy one. The one who never caused trouble. The one who made life easier for everyone else.

And nobody ever asked who was taking care of you.

Because the good child doesn't need anything. The good child is self-sufficient. The good child handles it. The good child is the parent's relief, not the parent's concern.

But here's what happens to the good child when he grows up: he becomes a man who can't ask for help. A man who gives and gives until there's nothing left. A man who is everyone's support system and nobody's priority.

The good child wound is rarely discussed because the good child is still being good. Still performing. Still making sure everyone else is okay.

But who is making sure you're okay?

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The good child wound: you were the easy one. The one who never needed anything. Now you're a man who gives until there's nothing left. Who makes sure you're okay? ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 138

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-14

LinkedIn:

Nobody checked in. So you stopped expecting it.

This is one of the most quietly devastating sentences a man can carry.

Think back. When was the last time someone asked you 'how are you, really?' ? and waited for the real answer?

For most men, the answer is never. Or so long ago that the memory feels borrowed.

You learned early that nobody was coming. That your inner world was your own responsibility ? and your own burden to carry alone. So you built a life around not needing anyone to check in. You became self-sufficient. Reliable. Unshakeable.

But self-sufficiency is not the same as wholeness. And the absence of asking does not mean the absence of need.

Here's what happens when a man stops expecting anyone to check in:

1. He stops checking in with himself. If nobody else cares, why should he?

2. He stops knowing what he feels. The inner world goes dark from neglect.
3. He becomes a caretaker of others while being unable to receive care.
4. He mistakes isolation for strength.
5. He wonders, in quiet moments, why he feels so alone even when surrounded by people.

The cultural message is clear: men don't need checking in. Men handle it. Men are the ones who check in on others.

But that message is a lie that costs men their lives ? literally. Men die by suicide at rates that should shame every society that perpetuates this lie.

At FOLA, we're building a different story. One where men are allowed to need. Where checking in is not weakness but courage. Where the man who says 'I'm not okay' is not broken ? he's finally honest.

Nobody checked in. So you stopped expecting it.

But you don't have to stop needing it.

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Facebook:

Nobody checked in. So you stopped expecting it. But stopping the expectation didn't stop the need. Men don't have to carry it alone. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 139

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-15

LinkedIn:

What you thought was resilience was dissociation.

You didn't 'get through it.' You left your body and never came back.

When a child experiences something too big to hold ? abuse, neglect, loss, chaos ? the psyche does what it must to survive. It separates. The part of you that felt the pain gets locked away. The part of you that functions keeps going.

And you kept going. You kept achieving. You kept providing. You kept being 'fine.'

But here's the problem: the part of you that got locked away didn't disappear. It went underground. And it's been running your life from the basement ever since.

That's why you can be successful and still feel empty. That's why you can be surrounded by people and still feel alone. That's why you can't cry even when you want to.

You didn't build resilience. You built a dissociative fortress. And the cost is that you can't feel the good things either.

Healing is not about tearing down the fortress. It's about being able to come and go freely ? and finally meeting the part of you that got left behind.

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Facebook:

What you thought was resilience was dissociation. You didn't get through it ? you left

your body and never came back. Healing means coming home. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 140

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-16

LinkedIn:

Your inner child is not cute. He is furious.

And he should be.

He was told to be quiet when he needed to speak. He was told to be strong when he needed to fall apart. He was told to stop crying when he needed to be held.

He learned that his needs were too much. That his feelings were inconvenient. That the people who were supposed to protect him were the ones he had to protect himself from.

And now he's a grown man who can't name what he feels. Who explodes at small things because the big things never got a voice. Who pushes people away before they can leave first.

Your inner child is not a cute metaphor. He is a living, breathing part of you that is still waiting for someone to finally see him, hear him, and tell him he matters.

Not as a performance. Not as a reward for being good. Just because he exists.

That's the work. Not to silence him again. But to finally let him speak.

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Facebook:

Your inner child is not cute. He is furious. And he should be. He's been waiting for someone to finally see him. Not silence him again ? let him speak. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 141

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-17

LinkedIn:

The first time your emotions were used against you.

You cried. And someone said 'stop crying or I'll give you something to cry about.'

You were angry. And someone said 'don't you dare raise your voice at me.'

You were sad. And someone said 'you have nothing to be sad about.'

You were excited. And someone said 'calm down, you're being too much.'

Every emotion you expressed was met with a correction. A punishment. A dismissal. And slowly, you learned that your feelings were not signals to be trusted ? they were liabilities to be managed.

So you managed them. You suppressed them. You locked them away.

And now you're a man who can't feel anything without judging it. Who doesn't trust his own

emotional responses. Who thinks being 'in control' means feeling nothing.

But here's the truth: emotions are not the enemy. They are information. And the man who can't read his own emotional data is flying blind through life.

At FOLA, we teach men to read the data again.

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Facebook:

The first time your emotions were used against you, you learned they were liabilities.

They're not. They're information. You've been flying blind. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 142

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18

LinkedIn:

What play was for. And what happened when it was taken away too soon.

Play is not a luxury. It is how children learn to regulate their nervous systems.

When a child plays, they are practicing safety. They are learning that the world can be explored, that mistakes are recoverable, that joy is allowed.

But when play is taken away too soon ? because life is too hard, because there's no space, because the child has to grow up fast ? something essential is lost.

The child becomes an adult who doesn't know how to rest. Who doesn't know how to have fun without guilt. Who treats life as a series of tasks to be completed rather than an experience to be lived.

You were not 'mature for your age.' You were a child who lost access to play. And the man who can't play is a man who can't truly connect ? because connection requires the same safety that play requires.

Healing is not just about processing trauma. It's about reclaiming the capacity for joy. For play. For being alive without performing for it.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

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Facebook:

Play is how children learn to regulate. When it's taken too soon, the man loses the

capacity for joy. Healing means reclaiming play. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 143

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-19

LinkedIn:

The absent father left a body behind.

This is not metaphor. This is biology.

Paternal abandonment has measurable effects on the developing male nervous system. Elevated cortisol. Dysregulated stress response. Changes in brain structure related to emotional regulation.

The absence of a father is not just a social problem. It is a physiological event that shapes how a boy's body learns to respond to the world.

Seven out of ten Black boys in South Africa are raised without fathers. That statistic is not abstract. It is 7 out of 10 nervous systems developing without a key regulatory presence.

The hypervigilance. The difficulty trusting male authority. The deep hunger for male approval that drives career choices, relationship patterns, and self-worth.

These are not character flaws. They are biological legacies of absence.

The work is not to blame the absent father. The work is to heal the body that was shaped by his absence.

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Facebook:

The absent father left a body behind. 7 out of 10 Black boys in SA are raised without fathers. That's not just social ? it's biological. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 144

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-20

LinkedIn:

Your father was present and still absent.

He came home every night. He paid the bills. He was at your graduation. He was in the house.

But he never arrived.

He was there physically and absent emotionally. A man who sat in the same room but never asked how your day was. Who provided everything except presence. Who was reliable in function and unavailable in feeling.

This wound is harder to name because there is no dramatic abandonment story. No door slamming. No 'your father left when you were three.'

Just a quiet, persistent vacancy. A man who was there and not there.

What that creates is a man who cannot name what he missed. Who feels guilty for being ungrateful because his father was 'there.' Who carries a longing he cannot justify.

But the wound is real. Emotional vacancy is a form of absence. And it leaves the same mark: a boy who grows up wondering why he wasn't worth showing up for.

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Facebook:

Your father was present and still absent. He was there physically and absent emotionally.

That wound is real ? even if you can't name it. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 145

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-21

LinkedIn:

You became everything your father wasn't. That's still about him.

You built yourself in opposition to his failures. You are present where he was absent. You are emotionally available where he was closed. You are successful where he struggled.

You did the work. You broke the cycle. You should be free.

But here's the thing: opposition is still a relationship.

Every decision you make that is driven by 'I will not be like him' is still a decision made in reference to him. He is still the centre of your identity, even if you are running in the opposite direction.

The overachiever built against a blueprint he hates is still defined by that blueprint.

The question is not 'Am I like my father?' The question is 'Who am I when I am not reacting to him?'

That is the freedom that comes after the opposition. When you are not running from his shadow, but standing in your own light.

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Facebook:

You became everything your father wasn't. That's still about him. Opposition is still a relationship. The real question: who are you when you're not reacting to him? ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 146

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-22

LinkedIn:

The moment you stopped looking for him.

There is an age when most men stop waiting for their father. For some it is 12. For others it is 25. For some it is the day they become fathers themselves and realise he is never going to show up the way they needed.

That moment is not liberation. It is resignation.

You didn't stop wanting him to show up. You stopped expecting it. Those are different things.

Underneath the resignation is a grief that has never been fully expressed. A grief that says 'I needed you and you were not there. And I have accepted that you will never be there. And that acceptance is its own kind of death.'

Many men mistake this resignation for healing. 'I've made peace with it.'

But peace is not the same as processed. Acceptance is not the same as healed.

The grief is still in the body. It shows up in the way you struggle to trust men. In the way you need constant validation from authority figures. In the way you parent your own children with a vigilance that is really fear.

The work is not to wait for him again. The work is to grieve what you never got, so you can stop carrying the weight of waiting.

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Facebook:

The moment you stopped looking for him wasn't liberation. It was resignation. You didn't stop wanting ? you stopped expecting. That grief is still in your body. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 147

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-23

LinkedIn:

What the father wound did to your authority.

Men with unhealed father wounds tend to fall into one of two patterns at work:

1. Collapse. You struggle to assert yourself. You defer to authority figures. You avoid conflict. You cannot hold boundaries with bosses or colleagues. You are the reliable, agreeable one who never gets promoted because you don't advocate for yourself.
2. Over-compensation. You resist all authority. You cannot take direction. You see every suggestion as criticism. You need to be the leader in every room because being led triggers something unbearable.

Both patterns are the same wound expressing differently. Both are about a man who never had a safe male authority figure to learn from.

The father wound shows up in the boardroom as surely as it shows up in the bedroom.

Leadership development that doesn't address the father wound is surface-level. You can teach a man to lead, but if his nervous system collapses or rebels when authority is present, the training will not hold.

The work is to heal the relationship with authority at its source.

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Facebook:

The father wound shows up in the boardroom as surely as it shows up in the bedroom. Two patterns: collapse or over-compensation. Both need healing at the source. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 148

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-24

LinkedIn:

What the father wound did to your God.

For men raised in Christian or traditional African contexts, the father wound has a spiritual dimension that is rarely discussed.

If your earthly father was absent, harsh, or unpredictable, how do you relate to a Heavenly Father?

Many men project their father's characteristics onto God. If your father was distant, God feels distant. If your father was punitive, God feels punitive. If your father was absent, you struggle to believe God is present.

Or the opposite: you create a God who is everything your father wasn't ? loving, present, gentle ? but you cannot actually feel that love because your nervous system has no template for safe fatherly love.

The theology of the absent father is a real thing. It shapes how men pray, how they trust, how they understand their place in the universe.

Healing the father wound often heals the spiritual wound too. Not because God changes. Because the template for receiving love changes.

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Facebook:

What the father wound did to your God. If your earthly father was absent or harsh, it shapes how you relate to a Heavenly Father. Healing one often heals the other. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 149

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

Your grandfather's pain is living in your spine.

Epigenetics is the study of how experience changes gene expression. What your grandfather survived ? apartheid, forced removals, the migrant labour system, the violence of being a Black man in a country designed to break him ? did not end with him.

It changed his biology. And that biology was passed down.

The hypervigilance you carry. The way your body prepares for catastrophe even when things are calm. The deep, wordless knowing that safety is temporary.

That is not just your personal history. That is generational memory living in your nervous system.

This is not mysticism. This is science. Trauma changes the stress response system, and those changes are heritable.

The grief that travelled without a name is real. It arrived in your body before you had

words for it.

The work of healing is not just personal. It is ancestral. When you heal your nervous system, you are not just freeing yourself ? you are changing the legacy your children will inherit.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

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Facebook:

Your grandfather's pain is living in your spine. Epigenetics shows trauma changes gene expression. Healing yourself is healing your ancestors. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 150

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-26

LinkedIn:

You raised yourself. That is not something to be proud of.

I know you're proud of it. You should be ? you survived without the support you deserved. You figured it out. You became a man without a blueprint.

But here's what I need you to hear: you raising yourself is not a testament to your strength. It is a testament to the failure of the adults who were supposed to raise you.

And the cost of raising yourself is that you never learned what you didn't learn. You don't know what you don't know. You built a foundation on guesswork and survival instincts.

That foundation has cracks. And those cracks show up in your relationships, your work, your parenting, your ability to trust, your ability to rest.

You raised yourself. And you did a remarkable job with what you had.

But you don't have to keep doing it alone. You don't have to keep being your own father. You can let someone help you fill in the cracks.

That is not weakness. That is completing what was left unfinished.

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Facebook:

You raised yourself. That's not something to be proud of ? it's a testament to adult failure. You did a remarkable job with what you had. You don't have to keep doing it alone. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 151

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-27

LinkedIn:

What 7 out of 10 actually feels like from inside the number.

Seven out of ten Black boys in South Africa grow up without fathers.

I am one of those seven. And I know what that statistic feels like from the inside.

It feels like learning to shave by watching YouTube. It feels like your first job interview and having no idea how to be a man in a room full of men. It feels like becoming a father yourself and realising you have no template for what you're supposed to do.

It feels like the absence of a question you didn't know you were waiting to be asked: 'How are you becoming a man?'

Seven out of ten. That means in a classroom of 30 Black boys, 21 of them are navigating boyhood without a father. 21 of them are learning masculinity from peers, from media, from trial and error. 21 of them are carrying a wound that has no name.

This is not a pity narrative. This is a reality that demands a response.

At FOLA, we don't just talk about the statistic. We work with the men inside it. We help them heal the wound that the number represents.

Because 7 out of 10 is not just a number. It is 7 out of 10 nervous systems trying to find their way home.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
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Facebook:

7 out of 10 Black boys in SA grow up without fathers. I am one of those seven. This is what that statistic feels like from the inside. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 152

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-28

LinkedIn:

The fear of becoming him.

You've spent your whole life trying not to be your father. Every decision filtered through the question: 'What would he do?' ? and then doing the opposite.

You've been successful at it. You're present where he was absent. You're gentle where he was harsh. You're available where he was distant.

But the fear of becoming him is still running the show. And fear is not freedom.

Here's what I've learned working with men: the fear of becoming your father keeps you in reaction to him. He is still the reference point. Still the centre of your identity, even if you're orbiting in the opposite direction.

The goal is not to be the opposite of your father. The goal is to be yourself ? without him as the reference point.

That is a different kind of freedom. Not freedom from him. Freedom from the fear of him.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
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Facebook:

The fear of becoming him is still running the show. The goal is not to be the opposite of your father. The goal is to be yourself ? without him as the reference point. ? Hakeem

Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 153

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29

LinkedIn:

Men have a mother wound too. We just don't get to say it.

The mother wound in men is one of the most silenced experiences in Black communities.

A boy who was smothered by his mother's love ? not allowed to separate, not allowed to become his own person ? grows into a man who doesn't know where his mother ends and he begins.

A boy whose mother was emotionally unavailable ? depressed, overwhelmed, working, surviving ? grows into a man who spends his life trying to earn love from unavailable women.

A boy whose mother used him as her confidant, her partner, her emotional husband ? grows into a man who cannot be in a relationship without caretaking.

We talk about the mother wound in women. We rarely talk about what it does to men.

Because men aren't supposed to need their mothers. Men aren't supposed to be affected by their mothers. Men are supposed to leave their mothers and become independent.

But the wound doesn't care about what you're supposed to do. It lives in your body. It shows up in every relationship you have with a woman.

Healing the mother wound is not about blaming her. It's about freeing yourself from the patterns she installed ? whether she meant to or not.

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Facebook:

Men have a mother wound too. We just don't get to say it. It shows up in every relationship with a woman. Healing it is not blame ? it's freedom. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 154

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-30

LinkedIn:

She was doing her best. It still hurt.

Both things can be true.

Your mother loved you. She sacrificed for you. She gave you what she had. She did things her mother never did for her.

And she also hurt you. Not because she wanted to. Because she was wounded herself. Because she was carrying generations of pain that she never had the language or safety to heal.

She passed down what was passed down to her. The patterns, the survival strategies, the ways of loving that were actually ways of coping.

This is the hardest truth for men to hold: gratitude and grief can coexist.

You can honour your mother's sacrifice AND acknowledge the ways she failed you. You can love her AND need to heal from her.

The work is not to choose one truth over the other. The work is to hold both. To say 'she did her best' and 'her best was not enough for what I needed.'

That is not betrayal. That is honesty. And honesty is the foundation of real healing.

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Facebook:

She was doing her best. It still hurt. Both things can be true. Gratitude and grief can coexist. Holding both is not betrayal ? it's honesty. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 155

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-01

LinkedIn:

The mother who loved you more than she healed herself.

She gave you everything she had. She worked herself to exhaustion. She made sure you had what she didn't. She poured into you until there was nothing left for herself.

But here's the problem: she couldn't give you what she didn't have.

She couldn't teach you emotional regulation because she never learned it. She couldn't model healthy boundaries because she had none. She couldn't show you how to rest because she had never rested in her life.

She loved you with everything she had. But everything she had was shaped by her own unhealed wounds.

And so you inherited not just her love, but her limitations. Not just her strength, but her survival patterns.

The work is not to blame her for what she couldn't give. The work is to recognise that her love, as real as it was, was not enough to heal what was passed down.

Only you can do that work. For yourself. And for the generations after you.

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Facebook:

She loved you more than she healed herself. She gave you everything she had ? including her limitations. Her love was real. It wasn't enough to heal what was passed down. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 156

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-02

LinkedIn:

The boy who became her partner when Dad left.

When the father is absent, someone has to fill the role. And too often, that someone is the son.

You became her confidant. Her emotional support. The man of the house at 10, 11, 12 years old.

You listened to her complaints about men. You comforted her when she cried. You took on responsibilities that no child should carry.

And you were praised for it. 'You're such a good boy.' 'You're my little man.' 'I don't know what I'd do without you.'

But that praise came with a cost. You learned that your value was in taking care of her. That your needs came second. That love meant being responsible for someone else's emotional state.

Now you're an adult and you cannot be in a relationship without becoming a caretaker. You attract partners who need to be saved. You cannot receive care because you only know how to give it.

You were never allowed to just be a child. And now you don't know how to just be a man ? without being responsible for everyone around you.

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Facebook:

The boy who became her partner when Dad left. You were praised for being 'the man of the house' at 10. Now you can't be in a relationship without caretaking. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 157

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-03

LinkedIn:

The way she spoke about women taught you everything.

Your mother's voice is the first voice you heard about women. The way she spoke about herself, about other women, about what women want and need and deserve ? that became your template.

If she spoke about women with resentment, you learned that women are a burden.

If she spoke about women as objects, you learned that women are for use.

If she spoke about women as victims, you learned that women need saving.

If she spoke about herself with contempt, you learned that women are not to be trusted ? because if she doesn't trust herself, why should you?

This is not about blaming your mother. This is about recognising that the first

relationship you witnessed between a man and a woman was the one she modelled ? even if she didn't know she was modelling it.

The way you treat women is not just your story. It is her story too. And until you examine that story, you will keep repeating it.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

The way she spoke about women taught you everything. Your mother's voice is the first template for how you see women. Examine that story ? or keep repeating it. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 158

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-04

LinkedIn:

Forgiving your mother is not the same as excusing her.

There is a difference between understanding why she did what she did and pretending it didn't hurt.

Many men are pressured to forgive their mothers without ever being allowed to grieve. 'She did her best.' 'She sacrificed for you.' 'You only have one mother.'

All of that is true. And none of it erases the wound.

Forgiveness that bypasses grief is not forgiveness. It is avoidance dressed up as grace.

Real forgiveness is not a bypass. It is the result of having fully felt the pain, fully named the loss, fully grieved what you didn't get ? and then choosing to release the resentment.

You cannot release what you have not held. You cannot forgive what you have not felt.

If you've 'forgiven your mother' but you still can't talk about your childhood without your chest tightening, you haven't forgiven her. You've just learned to perform forgiveness.

The real thing comes after the grief. Not before it.

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Forgiving your mother is not the same as excusing her. Forgiveness that bypasses grief is not forgiveness ? it's avoidance dressed up as grace. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 159

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-05

LinkedIn:

What it means to grieve a mother who is still alive.

This is one of the most confusing griefs a man can carry.

Your mother is alive. She is here. You can call her. You can visit her. She is physically present.

But the mother you needed ? the one who would see you, hold you, affirm you, celebrate you ? that mother never existed. Or she existed in moments that were too brief to build a foundation on.

So you grieve someone who is still breathing. You grieve the mother you needed but never had. You grieve the relationship that could have been but wasn't.

And the grief is confusing because you feel guilty. How dare you grieve someone who is still alive? How dare you feel loss when she is still here?

But the loss is real. The mother you needed is gone ? not because she died, but because she was never fully present to begin with.

Grieving that is not betrayal. It is the recognition of a real absence. And it is the first step toward freeing yourself from the hope that she will one day become who you needed her to be.

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Grieving a mother who is still alive is one of the most confusing griefs. The mother you needed never existed. Grieving that is not betrayal ? it's honesty. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 160

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-06

LinkedIn:

The strong mother created the son who can't rest.

She was strong. Unshakeable. The one who held everything together. The one who never broke.

And she raised you to be the same.

'Be strong.' 'Don't cry.' 'Handle it.' 'You're a man.'

She taught you strength by example. She showed you that survival means never stopping, never resting, never showing weakness.

But here's what she didn't know: the strength she modelled was not strength. It was endurance. It was dissociation. It was a woman running on empty with no permission to stop.

And she passed that legacy to you.

Now you're a man who cannot rest without guilt. Who cannot say 'I need help.' Who pushes through illness, exhaustion, and emotional collapse because stopping feels like failure.

The strong mother created the son who doesn't know how to be weak. And the son who doesn't know how to be weak is a son who doesn't know how to be human.

Strength is not the absence of weakness. Strength is the ability to be both strong and weak ? and know when each is called for.

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The strong mother created the son who can't rest. She taught you endurance, not strength. Now you can't stop without guilt. Strength is knowing when to be weak. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 161

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-07

LinkedIn:

She needed you to be fine. So you were fine.

Your mother had enough to carry. She was working, raising children, managing a household, carrying her own wounds. She didn't have the capacity to hold your pain too.

So you learned to be fine. You learned to hide your struggles. You learned to say 'I'm okay' when you were falling apart.

Because if you weren't fine, she would worry. And if she worried, she would break. And if she broke, who would hold everything together?

So you held yourself. You became the one who doesn't need anything. The one who handles it. The one who is always okay.

But being always okay is not okay. It is a performance that costs you your authenticity. It is a mask that suffocates the real you.

She needed you to be fine. So you were fine.

But you don't have to be fine anymore. You can be honest. You can be struggling. You can be not okay.

And the world will not end.

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She needed you to be fine. So you were fine. You learned to hide your struggles because she had enough to carry. You don't have to be fine anymore. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 162

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-08

LinkedIn:

The side dish.

In many Black households, the father is the main course. The mother is the side dish. And the children are the leftovers.

But when the father is absent, the mother becomes the main course ? and the son becomes the side dish.

You were never the priority. You were what she turned to when she was lonely. You were the stand-in for the man who wasn't there. You were the emotional support, the companion, the reason to keep going.

But you were never just a child who needed to be parented. You were always serving a function.

And that function taught you that your value is in what you provide, not who you are. That love is transactional. That you exist to fill a gap in someone else's life.

The side dish doesn't know he's a side dish until he tries to be the main course in his own life ? and realises he doesn't know how.

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The side dish. When the father is absent, the son becomes the stand-in. You learned your value is in what you provide, not who you are. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 163

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-09

LinkedIn:

You don't trust yourself. You just perform confidence.

There is a difference between confidence and performance. Confidence is quiet. Performance is loud. Confidence doesn't need an audience. Performance requires one.

You learned to perform confidence because the alternative ? admitting you don't know, you're not sure, you're scared ? was never safe.

So you became the one who always has an answer. The one who never hesitates. The one who projects certainty even when you're drowning in doubt.

But performing confidence is exhausting. It requires constant vigilance. One crack in the performance and the whole thing collapses.

Real confidence is not the absence of doubt. It is the ability to act in the presence of doubt. It is saying 'I don't know, but I'll figure it out' and meaning it.

The work is not to perform better. The work is to build a self that you can actually trust ? so you don't have to perform at all.

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You don't trust yourself. You just perform confidence. Real confidence is not the absence of doubt ? it's acting in the presence of it. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 164

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-10

LinkedIn:

Overthinking is a love language you learned in childhood.

You didn't come out of the womb analysing everything. You learned to overthink because thinking was the only control you had.

When your environment was unpredictable ? when you never knew which version of your parent you would get, when chaos could erupt at any moment ? your mind learned to scan. To anticipate. To prepare for every possible outcome.

Overthinking is not a personality trait. It is a survival strategy that outlived its usefulness.

You were trying to keep yourself safe by predicting every threat. But now you're safe. The threats are gone. And your mind is still scanning for danger that doesn't exist.

The cost is that you can't be present. You can't enjoy the moment. You can't trust that things are okay because your mind is always looking for what could go wrong.

Overthinking is not a sign of intelligence. It is a sign of an unhealed nervous system.

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Overthinking is a love language you learned in childhood. It's not a personality trait ? it's a survival strategy that outlived its usefulness. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 165

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-11

LinkedIn:

The self you perform and the self you are.

There is the version of you that shows up to work. The version that shows up to family gatherings. The version that shows up to dates. The version that shows up to church.

And then there is the version that exists when no one is watching.

For many men, these versions are so different that they don't recognise themselves in the quiet moments. The performance has become so automatic that the authentic self feels like a stranger.

This is not a moral failing. This is adaptation. You learned to be what each situation required because being yourself was not always safe.

But the cost of constant adaptation is that you lose touch with what is actually true about you. You become a collection of performances with no centre.

The work is not to stop adapting. The work is to find the centre that all the performances are protecting ? and to let that centre have a voice.

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The self you perform and the self you are. When the performances become automatic, the authentic self feels like a stranger. The work is finding the centre. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 166

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-12

LinkedIn:

You don't know what you want. You know what you're supposed to want.

A good job. A house. A car. A wife. Children. Respect. Stability.

These are not bad things. But are they what you actually want? Or are they what you were told to want?

From childhood, the script was written for you. Be a provider. Be responsible. Be the man who takes care of his family. Be the man who doesn't embarrass his name.

And you followed the script. You did what was expected. You built the life you were supposed to build.

But somewhere along the way, you stopped asking yourself what you actually wanted. Not for your family. Not for your reputation. For yourself.

And now you have the life you were supposed to want ? and you feel empty.

That emptiness is not ingratitude. It is the signal that you have been living someone else's definition of a good life.

The work is to find your own definition. And that requires the courage to admit that you don't know what you want yet.

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You don't know what you want. You know what you're supposed to want. The emptiness you feel is not ingratitude ? it's living someone else's definition of a good life. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 167

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-13

LinkedIn:

The version of yourself that learned silence.

There is a version of you that exists in the moments before you speak. The one who has something to say but swallows it. The one who has a boundary but doesn't set it. The one who is hurting but says 'I'm fine.'

That version learned silence because speaking had consequences.

You spoke up once and were shut down. You expressed a need and were dismissed. You showed vulnerability and it was used against you.

So you learned that silence is safer. That keeping it to yourself is the wise choice. That the less you say, the less can be used against you.

But silence has its own cost. The things you don't say don't disappear. They accumulate. They become resentment. They become distance. They become the gap between who you are and who you pretend to be.

The version of yourself that learned silence is not weak. He is wise. He learned a lesson that kept him safe.

But the lesson has expired. And the silence that once protected you is now isolating you.

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The version of yourself that learned silence. Speaking had consequences once. But the lesson has expired. The silence that protected you is now isolating you. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 168

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-14

LinkedIn:

Shame is not guilt. Guilt says 'I did something wrong.' Shame says 'I am something wrong.'

This distinction is one of the most important things I teach men.

Guilt is about behaviour. You did something that doesn't align with your values. Guilt is useful ? it tells you to correct course.

Shame is about identity. You believe there is something fundamentally wrong with you. Not something you did ? something you are.

Shame is not useful. Shame is a wound.

And shame is the hidden driver behind so many of the patterns that destroy men's lives:

- The man who can't receive love because he doesn't believe he deserves it.
- The man who sabotages success because being seen feels dangerous.
- The man who pushes people away before they can discover how flawed he is.
- The man who can't rest because resting means facing the emptiness inside.

Shame is not healed by affirmations. It is not healed by achievement. It is not healed by being told you're enough.

Shame is healed by being seen ? really seen ? by someone who doesn't look away. By telling the story of what happened to you and discovering that the listener doesn't recoil.

That is what therapeutic work provides. A space where the shame can finally speak. And discover that it was never the truth about you.

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Shame is not guilt. Guilt says 'I did something wrong.' Shame says 'I am something wrong.'
Shame is a wound ? and it's healed by being seen, not by achieving more. ? Hakeem Lesolang
| FOLA Polyclinics

Post 169

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-15

LinkedIn:

You've been performing your healing.

You read the books. You listened to the podcasts. You said the affirmations. You went to the workshop. You posted the quote.

And you told yourself you were healing.

But you weren't healing. You were collecting information about healing and mistaking it for the real thing.

Healing is not knowing what to do. Healing is doing what you know ? and feeling the discomfort of actually changing.

Reading about boundaries is not setting a boundary. Learning about inner child work is not sitting with your inner child. Understanding your father wound is not the same as grieving it.

The mind can understand something long before the body is ready to release it. And many men use understanding as a way to avoid feeling.

'I understand why I am this way' becomes the new defence. Because if you understand it, you don't have to feel it.

But healing happens in the body, not in the mind. It happens when you stop performing understanding and start experiencing the feelings you've been avoiding.

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You've been performing your healing. Reading about boundaries is not setting one.
Understanding your wound is not grieving it. Healing happens in the body, not the mind. ?
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Post 170

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-16

LinkedIn:

What you call intuition is your nervous system reporting from the past.

You trust your gut. You say 'something felt off.' You pride yourself on being able to read people and situations.

But here's what you need to know: your intuition is not always wisdom. Sometimes it is your nervous system recognising a pattern from the past and sounding the alarm.

You feel unsafe with a partner who is actually safe ? because your nervous system remembers the last time someone with that tone, that look, that energy hurt you.

You feel suspicious of an opportunity that is actually good ? because your nervous system remembers the last time something good turned out to be a trap.

Your intuition is not wrong. But it is not always responding to the present. It is responding to the past that the present reminds it of.

The work is not to ignore your intuition. The work is to learn the difference between intuition that is responding to now and intuition that is responding to then.

That is what therapy teaches you. To distinguish between the present and the past that lives in your body.

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Facebook:

What you call intuition is your nervous system reporting from the past. Your gut is not always responding to now ? sometimes it's responding to then. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 171

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-17

LinkedIn:

The thing you keep almost doing.

There is something you've been meaning to do for months. Maybe years. A conversation you need to have. A decision you need to make. A change you need to initiate.

You keep almost doing it. You get close. You rehearse it in your head. You feel the momentum building.

And then something stops you. A distraction. A doubt. A 'not yet.'

That 'not yet' is not procrastination. It is protection.

Your nervous system knows that taking this step will change things. And change, even good change, feels like danger to a system that learned that safety is sameness.

The thing you keep almost doing is the thing that will disrupt the equilibrium you've built ? even if that equilibrium is keeping you stuck.

The question is not 'how do I find the motivation?' The question is 'what am I afraid will happen if I actually do this?'

The answer to that question is where the real work begins.

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Facebook:

The thing you keep almost doing. That 'not yet' is not procrastination ? it's protection. Your nervous system knows this step will change things. What are you afraid will happen? ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 172

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-18

LinkedIn:

You were your own first bully.

Before anyone else could criticise you, you had already criticised yourself. Before anyone could reject you, you had already rejected yourself. Before anyone could tell you you weren't enough, you had already decided you weren't.

You became your own first bully because it was a way to control the pain. If you hurt yourself first, the hurt from others couldn't surprise you. If you already knew you were worthless, nobody could reveal it to you.

It was a defence. A terrible, effective defence.

But the defence has become the prison. The voice that was supposed to protect you from external criticism has become the loudest voice in your head. And it doesn't stop.

You wouldn't let anyone else speak to you the way you speak to yourself. You wouldn't tolerate a friend who said the things you say to yourself in your own mind.

But you tolerate it from yourself. Because somewhere, you still believe the bully is protecting you.

He's not. He's keeping you small. And he needs to be retired.

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You were your own first bully. Before anyone could reject you, you already had. That voice was a defence ? now it's a prison. You wouldn't let anyone speak to you the way you speak to yourself. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 173

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-19

LinkedIn:

What do you actually want? Not for your family. For yourself.

This is the question that stops most men cold.

They can tell you what they want for their children. They can tell you what they want for their parents. They can tell you what they want for their community.

But ask them what they want for themselves ? just themselves ? and the answer is silence.

Because wanting for yourself feels selfish. It feels dangerous. It feels like abandoning the people who depend on you.

But here's the truth: a man who doesn't know what he wants for himself is a man who will eventually resent everyone he sacrificed for.

The resentment doesn't look like anger. It looks like numbness. It looks like going through the motions. It looks like being present but not really there.

You cannot pour from an empty cup. But more importantly, you cannot pour from a cup that was never yours to begin with.

Finding out what you actually want is not selfish. It is the most responsible thing you can do for the people who depend on you. Because a man who knows what he wants is a man who can give without resentment.

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What do you actually want? Not for your family. For yourself. A man who doesn't know what he wants will eventually resent everyone he sacrificed for. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 174

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-20

LinkedIn:

You built the wrong life. That's not a failure. That's information.

You followed the script. You did everything right. You got the degree, the job, the house, the relationship, the life you were supposed to build.

And now you're in it ? and it doesn't fit.

You feel trapped. You feel like you made a mistake. You feel like everyone else figured it out and you're the only one who built something that doesn't work.

But here's what I need you to hear: building the wrong life is not a failure. It is information.

It tells you that the script you were given was not written for you. It tells you that what you thought you wanted was what you were told to want. It tells you that you have the courage to admit that something is wrong ? and that is the first step toward building something right.

The man who built the wrong life and stays in it is not strong. He is afraid.

The man who built the wrong life and has the courage to rebuild ? that is strength.

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You built the wrong life. That's not a failure ? that's information. It tells you the script wasn't written for you. The courage to rebuild is strength. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 175

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-21

LinkedIn:

Church gave you a purpose that wasn't yours.

For many Black men, the church was the first place that gave you a sense of purpose. You were told you were called. You were told you had a destiny. You were told God had a plan for your life.

And that was powerful. For a boy who had no sense of direction, being told you had a divine purpose was life-giving.

But for many men, the purpose the church gave you was not your own. It was the church's purpose for you. It was what the institution needed you to be: a leader, a servant, a provider, a good man in someone else's definition.

And when you outgrew that definition ? or when it stopped working ? you were left with nothing. Because you never developed your own sense of purpose. You borrowed one.

The crisis of purpose that many men face in their 30s and 40s is often a spiritual crisis. Not because they lost God. But because they lost the borrowed purpose that God was supposed to validate.

The work is not to find a new church. The work is to find your own purpose ? and then decide what role faith plays in it.

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Church gave you a purpose that wasn't yours. You borrowed it. When it stopped working, you were left with nothing. The work is finding your own purpose. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 176

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-22

LinkedIn:

The man who lost his business and lost himself.

For many men, their identity is their work. 'I am a businessman.' 'I am a provider.' 'I am the one who makes things happen.'

And then the business fails. Or the job ends. Or the career doesn't work out.

And the man doesn't just lose his income. He loses his identity. He doesn't know who he is without the title, the role, the function.

This is why men struggle so much with career transitions. It's not just about money. It's about the collapse of a self that was built entirely on what you do.

The man who lost his business and lost himself is not a failure. He is a man who needs to rebuild his identity on something more solid than a job title.

The work is not to find a new business. The work is to find a self that can survive the loss of any external role.

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Facebook:

The man who lost his business and lost himself. When identity is built entirely on work, losing the work means losing the self. Rebuild on something more solid. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 177

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-23

LinkedIn:

Passion is not a luxury for Black men. The absence of it is.

We are told that passion is a privilege. That Black men don't get to do what they love ? they do what they have to do. That survival comes first, and passion is for later.

But here's what I've learned working with men: the absence of passion is not a sign of maturity. It is a sign of disconnection.

A man who has no passion is a man who has lost access to his own aliveness. He goes through the motions. He provides. He fulfils his responsibilities. But he is not present. He is not excited. He is not fully alive.

And the people around him feel it. His children feel it. His partner feels it. They know they are living with a man who is there but not there.

Passion is not about quitting your job to paint. Passion is about finding the thing that makes you feel alive ? and making space for it in your life.

It could be coaching your son's soccer team. It could be writing. It could be building something with your hands. It could be mentoring young men.

Passion is not a luxury. It is a necessity. Without it, you are not living ? you are just surviving in a more comfortable way.

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Passion is not a luxury for Black men. The absence of it is. A man with no passion has lost access to his own aliveness. Passion is not a luxury ? it's a necessity. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 178

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-24

LinkedIn:

What does power mean to you? Not influence, not control. Power.

Most men have never been asked this question. And when they are, they give answers that are not their own.

Power is money. Power is status. Power is being in charge. Power is having people listen to you.

But those are external expressions of power. They are not power itself.

Real power is the ability to choose your response. Real power is the capacity to be with

discomfort without reacting. Real power is knowing who you are and what you stand for ? and not needing anyone to validate it.

The man who needs to control everything is not powerful. He is terrified.

The man who needs everyone to respect him is not powerful. He is desperate.

The man who can sit in silence, who can be wrong, who can apologise, who can feel his feelings without acting on them ? that man is powerful.

Power is not what you have. Power is who you are when you have nothing.

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Facebook:

What does power mean to you? Real power is the ability to choose your response. The capacity to be with discomfort without reacting. Power is who you are when you have nothing. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 179

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-25

LinkedIn:

The dream you stopped talking about.

There is a dream you had. Maybe it was a business. Maybe it was a creative project. Maybe it was a place you wanted to live. Maybe it was a version of yourself you wanted to become.

You stopped talking about it because the people around you didn't take it seriously. Or because life got in the way. Or because you told yourself it was unrealistic.

But the dream didn't die. It went underground. And it shows up in quiet moments ? when you see someone else doing what you wanted to do, and something twists in your chest.

That twist is not envy. It is grief. Grief for the part of yourself you abandoned.

The dream you stopped talking about is not dead. It is waiting. And the longer you ignore it, the louder it will become ? in the form of restlessness, dissatisfaction, and the feeling that something is missing.

The question is not 'is it realistic?' The question is 'what would it cost me to never try?'

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The dream you stopped talking about. It didn't die ? it went underground. That twist in your chest when you see someone else doing it? That's grief. The dream is waiting. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 180

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-26

LinkedIn:

Your calling might be the thing you've been ashamed of.

What if the thing you're meant to do is the thing you've been hiding?

The way you naturally help people. The subject you can't stop learning about. The problem you keep noticing that nobody else seems to see.

You've dismissed it as 'not serious.' As 'not a real career.' As something other people do, not you.

But what if the shame you feel about it is not a sign that it's wrong ? but a sign that it matters?

We are often most ashamed of the things that are most true about us. Because the truth is vulnerable. Because if you admit this is what you really want, you have to admit that the life you're living might not be the life you're meant for.

Your calling might not look like a calling. It might look like a hobby. It might look like a curiosity. It might look like something you do in secret.

But it keeps showing up. It keeps pulling your attention. It keeps whispering.

Maybe it's time to stop whispering back.

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Your calling might be the thing you've been ashamed of. We are often most ashamed of what is most true about us. Maybe it's time to stop whispering back. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 181

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-27

LinkedIn:

The man who provides but does not live.

He wakes up. He goes to work. He comes home. He pays the bills. He takes care of his family. He does what is expected.

But he does not live.

He does not feel joy. He does not pursue pleasure. He does not rest without guilt. He does not ask himself what he wants.

He is a function. A provider. A machine that converts time into money and money into security.

And he is dying inside.

The man who provides but does not live is the most common tragedy I see. He is praised by everyone. His family is proud of him. His community respects him. He is a 'good man.'

But he is not a happy man. He is not a fulfilled man. He is not a man who feels alive.

The work is not to stop providing. The work is to learn how to live alongside providing. To discover that you can be both a provider and a person. That your family needs you alive, not just employed.

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Facebook:

The man who provides but does not live. He is praised by everyone. He is dying inside. Your family needs you alive, not just employed. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 182

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-28

LinkedIn:

What you would do if nobody was watching and nobody was judging.

This is the question that reveals what you actually want.

Not what you should want. Not what would impress people. Not what would make your mother proud. Not what would look good on Instagram.

What you would do if nobody was watching and nobody was judging.

The answer to that question is the seed of your authentic life.

It might be small. It might be terrifying. It might be something you've never admitted to anyone.

But it is yours. And it is real.

The tragedy is not that you can't do it. The tragedy is that you've spent so long living for an audience that you don't even know what you would choose if the audience disappeared.

The work is to find that answer. And then to have the courage to move toward it ? one step at a time, even while the audience is still watching.

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Facebook:

What would you do if nobody was watching and nobody was judging? That answer is the seed of your authentic life. The tragedy is you've spent so long living for an audience. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 183

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-29

LinkedIn:

You don't have a career. You have a wound with a salary.

You chose your career for reasons you don't fully understand. Security ? because you grew

up without it. Status ? because you needed to prove something. Approval ? because you never got enough of it.

Your career is not a calling. It is a compensation.

You are overworking because rest feels unsafe. You are chasing promotions because being seen feels like survival. You cannot say no because boundaries feel like rejection.

The same wound that drove you to succeed is now the wound that is burning you out.

And the tragedy is: the success doesn't heal the wound. It just gives it a better salary.

The work is not to quit your job. The work is to uncouple your career from your wound. To work because you choose to, not because you need to prove something.

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Facebook:

You don't have a career. You have a wound with a salary. The success doesn't heal the wound ? it just gives it a better salary. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 184

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-30

LinkedIn:

Why Black men overwork and call it ambition.

There is a difference between ambition and overwork. Ambition is driven by vision. Overwork is driven by fear.

Black men overwork because we learned early that we have to be twice as good to get half as much. That there is no margin for error. That if we stop, we fall behind ? and falling behind is not an option.

We overwork because rest feels like a luxury we haven't earned. Because saying no feels like risking everything. Because the anxiety of not doing enough is worse than the exhaustion of doing too much.

We call it ambition. We call it hustle. We call it grind.

But underneath it is a nervous system that doesn't believe it is safe enough to stop.

The work is not to stop working. The work is to work from a place of choice, not compulsion. To build a relationship with work that is not driven by the fear of being nothing without it.

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Why Black men overwork and call it ambition. Ambition is driven by vision. Overwork is driven by fear. The work is to work from choice, not compulsion. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 185

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-31

LinkedIn:

Success that didn't heal you is just a better disguise.

You got the promotion. You made the money. You bought the things. You achieved the goals.

And you still feel the same emptiness you felt before.

Because success doesn't heal. It distracts. It gives you something to focus on so you don't have to face what's underneath.

The man who achieves to avoid his pain is still in pain ? he just has a nicer view.

The man who builds an empire to prove his worth still doesn't believe he is worthy ? he just has more evidence to argue against the feeling.

Success is not the opposite of brokenness. You can be successful and broken. Many of the most 'successful' men I work with are also the most broken.

The work is not to achieve more. The work is to heal the part of you that believes achievement will save you.

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Success that didn't heal you is just a better disguise. You can be successful and broken.

The work is not to achieve more ? it's to heal the part that believes achievement will save you. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 186

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-01

LinkedIn:

The Black man in the boardroom who is still the boy from the township.

He has the corner office. The executive title. The salary that would make his grandmother cry.

But inside, he is still the boy who learned that his voice doesn't matter. That speaking up has consequences. That he has to be careful, strategic, never fully himself.

He is in the room. But he is not free in the room.

He watches his white colleagues speak with an ease he cannot access. He measures every word. He calculates the cost of authenticity. He performs confidence while his nervous system is in survival mode.

This is not imposter syndrome. This is the legacy of growing up Black in a country that told you, in a thousand ways, that you don't belong in rooms like this.

The boardroom doesn't heal the township wound. It just gives it a better view.

The work is not to leave the boardroom. The work is to heal the part of you that still believes you don't belong there ? so you can finally be fully present in the rooms you've

earned the right to occupy.

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The Black man in the boardroom who is still the boy from the township. He's in the room.

But he's not free in the room. The work is healing the part that still believes he doesn't

belong. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 187

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-02

LinkedIn:

What imposter syndrome actually is in the South African context.

Imposter syndrome is often described as an individual psychological problem. 'You just need to believe in yourself.'

But for Black men in South Africa, imposter syndrome is not just personal. It is systemic.

You grew up in a system designed to tell you that you are less than. That certain spaces are not for you. That your success is an exception, not the rule.

You were the first in your family to go to university. The first to get a corporate job.

The first to own a business. The first to sit in a boardroom.

And every step of the way, the message was: you are lucky to be here. Don't mess it up.

Don't forget where you come from. Don't get too comfortable.

That voice is not just your inner critic. It is the internalised voice of a system that was not designed for your success.

Imposter syndrome in the South African context is not a lack of confidence. It is a rational response to being in spaces that were never designed for you.

The healing is not to 'believe in yourself more.' The healing is to recognise that the voice of the imposter is not the truth ? it is the echo of a system that is finally losing.

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What imposter syndrome actually is in the South African context. It's not just personal ?

it's systemic. The voice of the imposter is the echo of a system that is finally losing. ?

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Post 188

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-03

LinkedIn:

You got the promotion. Why do you still feel like you're waiting to be found out?

Because the promotion didn't change the story you tell yourself about who you are.

You still believe, somewhere deep, that you got lucky. That they haven't figured out yet that you don't really know what you're doing. That one day, someone will discover the truth ? and everything will collapse.

This is not humility. This is a wound that no achievement can fill.

The wound says: 'I am not enough. I must prove otherwise.'

And every achievement is just temporary evidence against a permanent belief. The evidence expires. The belief remains.

You got the promotion. You earned it. You deserve to be there.

But until you believe that in your body ? not just in your mind ? you will keep waiting for the other shoe to drop.

The work is not to achieve more. The work is to internalise what you have already achieved.

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You got the promotion. Why do you still feel like you're waiting to be found out? Because no achievement can fill the wound that says 'I am not enough.' The work is to internalise what you've already achieved. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 189

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-04

LinkedIn:

Poverty-mindedness is not a money problem. It's a nervous system problem.

We talk about poverty-mindedness as if it's about money. As if the solution is more financial education, better budgeting, smarter investing.

But poverty-mindedness is not about what you know about money. It is about what your nervous system learned about safety.

When you grow up in scarcity, your nervous system learns that resources are finite, that safety is temporary, that you must hold on to what you have because there may not be more.

This is not a mindset. This is a physiological adaptation to an environment of lack.

And here's the problem: even when the environment changes ? even when you have money ? the nervous system doesn't automatically update. It still operates from the old programming.

That's why you can have money in the bank and still feel poor. That's why you can earn more and still make decisions from scarcity. That's why you can't spend on yourself without guilt. That's why you hoard, overwork, and can't enjoy what you have.

Poverty-mindedness is not cured by a raise. It is cured by healing the nervous system's relationship with safety.

When your body finally believes that you are safe, the scarcity patterns begin to release. Not because you have more money. Because you have more trust.

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Poverty-mindedness is not a money problem. It's a nervous system problem. You can have money in the bank and still feel poor. The cure is not a raise ? it's healing your relationship with safety. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 190

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-05

LinkedIn:

The first million didn't fix it. Here's why.

You thought the money would change everything. You imagined the relief, the freedom, the peace.

And then you got it. And the relief lasted a week. And then the old anxiety came back ? just with a bigger number attached.

Because the money didn't change the fundamental relationship you have with yourself.

You still don't trust that you're safe. You still don't believe you deserve what you have. You still feel like it could all disappear at any moment.

The money just gave you more to lose.

This is the trap that successful men fall into: they keep chasing the next number, believing that THIS time it will be enough. But it never is. Because the problem was never the number. The problem was the belief that the number would fix something that numbers cannot fix.

The first million didn't fix it. Neither will the second. The only thing that fixes it is healing the part of you that believes you need more to be enough.

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The first million didn't fix it. The money just gave you more to lose. The problem was never the number ? it was the belief that the number would fix something numbers cannot fix. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 191

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-06

LinkedIn:

You were raised to survive poverty. Nobody taught you how to build in safety.

Your parents taught you how to survive. How to stretch a rand. How to prepare for the worst. How to never get comfortable because comfort is dangerous.

These lessons kept you alive. They are not wrong.

But they are incomplete.

Because surviving poverty and building wealth require different skills. Different nervous system states. Different relationships with risk, with time, with yourself.

Survival is reactive. Building is creative.

Survival is about avoiding loss. Building is about pursuing gain.

Survival is about scarcity. Building is about abundance.

You cannot build from a survival state. You can only survive from a survival state.

The work is not to unlearn survival. The work is to learn how to access the building state ? the calm, creative, expansive state that allows you to build from safety rather than from fear.

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You were raised to survive poverty. Nobody taught you how to build in safety. Survival is reactive. Building is creative. You cannot build from a survival state. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 192

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-07

LinkedIn:

The colleague who snapped. The executive who drank. The CEO who quit.

You've seen them. The colleague who was fine until he wasn't. The executive who kept it together until he couldn't. The CEO who had everything and walked away.

You told yourself it wouldn't happen to you. You're stronger. You have better coping mechanisms. You know how to handle it.

But here's what you don't see: they all said the same thing.

The man who snaps doesn't snap because of one thing. He snaps because he has been carrying a thousand things for twenty years, and one day the thousand-and-first thing is the one that breaks him.

The executive who drinks doesn't drink because of the pressure. He drinks because he never learned any other way to regulate his nervous system.

The CEO who quits doesn't quit because he's ungrateful. He quits because he built a life that looked successful from the outside and felt empty from the inside.

These are not cautionary tales about other people. They are previews of what happens when men don't do the work.

The work is not to avoid breaking. The work is to build a life that doesn't require you to hold yourself together all the time.

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The colleague who snapped. The executive who drank. The CEO who quit. They all said 'it won't happen to me.' The work is building a life that doesn't require you to hold yourself together all the time. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 193

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-08

LinkedIn:

You are not lazy. You are exhausted by the performance.

You call yourself lazy because you can't bring yourself to do the thing you know you should do. You beat yourself up for procrastinating. You tell yourself that if you just had more discipline, you would be further ahead.

But what if you're not lazy? What if you're exhausted?

Not physically exhausted. Existentially exhausted. Exhausted by the constant performance of being someone you're not. Exhausted by the effort of maintaining a facade. Exhausted by the gap between who you pretend to be and who you actually are.

That exhaustion is not laziness. It is the cost of inauthenticity.

When your energy is being drained by maintaining a false self, you don't have energy left for the things that matter. The procrastination is not a character flaw. It is your system telling you that something is wrong.

The solution is not more discipline. The solution is to stop performing. To reduce the gap between who you are and who you pretend to be. To reclaim the energy that is being spent on maintaining the facade.

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You are not lazy. You are exhausted by the performance. The procrastination is not a character flaw ? it's your system telling you something is wrong. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 194

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-09

LinkedIn:

Perfectionism is not a standard. It's a defence.

You think perfectionism is about excellence. You think it's about holding yourself to a high standard. You're proud of it.

But perfectionism is not about excellence. It is about avoiding criticism. It is about making yourself so flawless that nobody can find anything to attack.

Perfectionism is a defence against shame. If I am perfect, nobody can reject me. If I am perfect, I am safe.

But perfection is impossible. So you are never safe. You are always finding flaws. Always falling short. Always feeling like you could have done more.

Perfectionism doesn't make you excellent. It makes you exhausted. It makes you afraid to try new things because you might not be good at them immediately. It makes you procrastinate because starting means risking imperfection.

The work is not to lower your standards. The work is to separate your worth from your performance. To do good work because you want to, not because you need to be perfect to be acceptable.

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Perfectionism is not a standard. It's a defence against shame. It doesn't make you excellent ? it makes you exhausted. Separate your worth from your performance. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 195

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-10

LinkedIn:

Why you start everything and finish nothing.

You have twenty projects in various stages of incompleteness. You get excited about a new idea, dive in, work intensely for a week ? and then lose interest.

You tell yourself you lack discipline. You tell yourself you're a starter, not a finisher.

But here's what's really happening: you start things because starting feels good. Starting is safe. Starting is full of possibility. Starting doesn't require you to face the fear of not being good enough.

Finishing requires you to face that fear. Finishing means putting something out into the world where it can be judged. Finishing means confronting the possibility that your best might not be good enough.

So you start something new, where the possibility is still infinite and the judgment hasn't arrived yet. And you leave the old thing unfinished, where it can't be judged.

The problem is not that you can't finish. The problem is that finishing requires you to tolerate the discomfort of being seen.

The work is not to find more discipline. The work is to build the capacity to be seen ? even when you're not sure your work is good enough.

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Why you start everything and finish nothing. Starting is safe. Finishing means being seen. The problem is not discipline ? it's the fear of judgment. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 196

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-11

LinkedIn:

The excuse that became a personality trait.

You've been saying it so long you don't even recognise it as an excuse anymore.

'I'm just not a morning person.' 'I work better under pressure.' 'I'm not good with confrontation.' 'I'm just an introvert.' 'That's just how I am.'

These started as explanations. They became identities.

And identities are hard to change because changing them feels like losing yourself.

But here's the question: is 'that's just how I am' protecting you from something? Is it keeping you from having to try? From having to risk failure? From having to face the possibility that you could be more than you've settled for?

The excuse that became a personality trait is not who you are. It is who you settled for.

And you settled for it because it was easier than facing the fear of becoming more.

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The excuse that became a personality trait. 'That's just how I am' is not who you are ? it's who you settled for because becoming more was scarier. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 197

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-12

LinkedIn:

You sabotage it when it starts to work. That's not self-destruction. That's loyalty.

You get close to success ? and something happens. You pick a fight. You get sick. You make a mistake. You disappear.

You call it self-sabotage. You beat yourself up for it.

But what if it's not self-destruction? What if it's loyalty?

Loyalty to the version of yourself that never had much. Loyalty to your family who struggled while you're succeeding. Loyalty to the community that taught you that people like us don't make it.

Sabotage is not a desire to fail. It is a fear of succeeding and losing the people you love. It is a fear of becoming someone your family doesn't recognise. It is a fear of leaving behind the version of yourself that everyone knows.

You don't sabotage because you want to fail. You sabotage because success feels like betrayal.

The work is not to force yourself to succeed. The work is to heal the belief that success means losing your people. To discover that you can succeed AND stay connected. That your

success is not a betrayal ? it is a gift to the people who came before you.

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You sabotage it when it starts to work. That's not self-destruction ? that's loyalty.

Loyalty to the version of you that never had much. Success can feel like betrayal. ?

Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 198

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-13

LinkedIn:

Negative self-talk is not humility. It is abuse with a familiar voice.

You think you're being realistic. You think you're managing expectations. You think you're protecting yourself from disappointment.

But the voice that tells you you're not good enough, not smart enough, not worthy enough ? that voice is not humility. It is abuse.

And the worst part is: you believe it because it sounds like home. It sounds like the voices you grew up with. It sounds like the messages you internalised before you had the capacity to question them.

You would never speak to a friend the way you speak to yourself. You would never tolerate someone else saying to you what you say to yourself in your own mind.

But you tolerate it from yourself because somewhere, you still believe the abuse is protecting you. That if you keep yourself small, you'll be safe.

You won't be safe. You'll be small. And small is not safe ? it's just limited.

The work is to recognise the voice for what it is: an internalised abuser. And to start speaking to yourself the way you would speak to someone you love.

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Negative self-talk is not humility. It is abuse with a familiar voice. You would never speak to a friend the way you speak to yourself. Start speaking to yourself like someone you love. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 199

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-14

LinkedIn:

The fear of success nobody talks about.

We talk about the fear of failure all the time. But the fear of success is just as real ? and less discussed.

Success means visibility. Success means responsibility. Success means people will expect

things from you. Success means you can no longer use 'I'm working on it' as an excuse.

Success means leaving behind the version of yourself that everyone knows. It means becoming someone new ? and not knowing if people will still love the new you.

For Black men, success also means something else: it means being the first. The first in your family to make it. The first to break the ceiling. The first to have what your parents never had.

And being first is lonely. There is no template. There is no one to show you how. There is only the pressure of representing your family, your community, your race.

The fear of success is not about failing. It is about succeeding and not knowing how to handle it.

The work is not to eliminate the fear. The work is to build the capacity to hold success ? to develop the internal structure that can handle what you're building.

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The fear of success nobody talks about. Success means visibility, responsibility, becoming someone new. For Black men, it also means being first ? and being first is lonely. ?
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Post 200

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-15

LinkedIn:

What qualifiers are doing in your speech.

'I think...' 'I'm not sure but...' 'This might be wrong but...' 'Just my opinion...'
'Sorry to interrupt but...'

These are qualifiers. They are words you put before your statements to soften them. To make them less threatening. To give yourself an exit in case your statement is rejected.

Qualifiers are not politeness. They are protection.

You learned to qualify your speech because speaking directly had consequences. You were told you were too much. You were told to watch your tone. You were told that your opinion wasn't welcome.

So you learned to preface every statement with an apology. To make your voice smaller so it wouldn't be attacked.

But qualifiers don't make you safer. They make you invisible. They signal that you don't trust your own voice. They tell people that what you're about to say is not important enough to state directly.

The work is not to become aggressive. The work is to learn to speak without apologising for existing. To state your truth directly ? and to tolerate the discomfort of being seen.

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Facebook:

What qualifiers are doing in your speech. 'I think...' 'Just my opinion...' These are not politeness ? they are protection. They make you invisible. Learn to speak without apologising for existing. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 201

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-16

LinkedIn:

The habit of being the second best version of yourself.

You know you have more in you. You can feel it. There is a version of you that is more focused, more disciplined, more present, more alive.

But you don't become that version. You stay in the second best version. The one that does enough to get by. The one that keeps the status quo. The one that doesn't risk too much.

Why?

Because the best version of yourself is dangerous. The best version of yourself would require you to change. Would require you to let go of the excuses. Would require you to face the possibility that you might fail ? or worse, that you might succeed and have to sustain it.

The second best version is comfortable. It is known. It is safe.

But it is also a prison. A prison of 'almost.' Almost successful. Almost happy. Almost fulfilled. Almost the man you could be.

The habit of being the second best version of yourself is not laziness. It is fear. Fear of what would happen if you actually became who you are capable of being.

The work is to make the best version more familiar than the second best. To practice being him until he is no longer dangerous.

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The habit of being the second best version of yourself. You know there's more in you. But the best version is dangerous ? it would require change. The second best is a prison of 'almost.' ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 202

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-17

LinkedIn:

You know what to do. Why aren't you doing it?

You've read the books. You've listened to the podcasts. You've watched the videos. You know exactly what you need to do.

But you're not doing it.

And you beat yourself up for it. You call yourself lazy. You call yourself undisciplined.

You wonder what's wrong with you.

But here's what I've learned: knowing and doing are not on the same continuum. They are different capacities.

Knowing is cognitive. Doing requires your nervous system to be regulated enough to tolerate the discomfort of change.

You know you need to set boundaries. But setting a boundary means risking conflict. And your nervous system learned that conflict is dangerous.

You know you need to start that business. But starting means risking failure. And your nervous system learned that failure is not an option.

You know what to do. But knowing is not the gap. Regulation is the gap.

The work is not to learn more. The work is to heal your nervous system enough that you can tolerate the discomfort of doing what you know.

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You know what to do. Why aren't you doing it? Knowing is cognitive. Doing requires a regulated nervous system. The gap is not knowledge ? it's the capacity to tolerate discomfort. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 203

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-18

LinkedIn:

What poverty taught your brain about possibility.

Poverty is not just a lack of money. It is a narrowing of the possible.

When you grow up in scarcity, your brain learns that the range of possible outcomes is small. That things don't work out. That hoping is dangerous. That the safe bet is to expect the worst.

This is not pessimism. This is pattern recognition.

Your brain learned the patterns of your environment and adapted accordingly. In an environment of scarcity, expecting less is adaptive. It protects you from disappointment.

But here's the problem: the adaptation outlives the environment.

You are no longer in the scarcity environment. But your brain is still operating from the old patterns. It still narrows the range of what it considers possible. It still defaults to 'that won't work.' It still expects the worst.

What poverty taught your brain about possibility was a survival lesson. But survival lessons are not life lessons. They are context-specific adaptations.

The work is not to pretend the scarcity didn't happen. The work is to teach your brain that the context has changed ? and that the range of possibility is wider than it learned to see.

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What poverty taught your brain about possibility. It narrowed what you could see. The adaptation outlived the environment. The work is teaching your brain that the context has changed. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 204

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-19

LinkedIn:

The man who made it out and still can't spend on himself.

He has money now. Real money. Enough to buy what he needs, what his family needs, and more.

But he still can't spend on himself.

He hesitates at every purchase. He calculates and recalculates. He feels guilty for wanting something just for himself. He buys the cheapest option even when he can afford the best.

His children have what they need. His wife has what she needs. His parents are taken care of.

But he still wears the same shoes from three years ago. He still drives the car that needs repairs. He still denies himself the things that would make his life easier, more comfortable, more enjoyable.

This is not frugality. This is a wound.

The wound says: you don't deserve it. The wound says: it could all disappear tomorrow. The wound says: spending on yourself is selfish. The wound says: you are still the boy who had nothing, and the boy who had nothing doesn't get to have things.

The man who made it out and still can't spend on himself has not fully made it out. He has changed his circumstances but not his identity.

The work is not to spend recklessly. The work is to heal the part of you that still believes you don't deserve to have nice things.

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fola.co.za

Facebook:

The man who made it out and still can't spend on himself. He has money but still wears the same shoes from three years ago. He changed his circumstances but not his identity. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 205

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-20

LinkedIn:

Why you can't receive.

Someone offers you a compliment. You deflect it. Someone offers you help. You refuse it. Someone offers you a gift. You feel uncomfortable.

You are a master at giving. You are terrible at receiving.

This is not humility. This is a wound.

You learned early that receiving is dangerous. That if you receive, you owe. That if you receive, you are vulnerable. That if you receive, someone will use it against you.

So you built a life around not needing anything from anyone. You became the giver, the provider, the one who handles it. You made yourself indispensable so that nobody could leave you.

But the inability to receive is a prison. It cuts you off from love, from support, from the very things you need to thrive.

And it is exhausting. Being the one who always gives and never receives is not strength. It is a slow depletion.

The work is not to stop giving. The work is to learn that receiving is not dangerous. That you can accept a compliment without losing yourself. That you can receive help without being in debt. That you are worthy of being given to ? not just of giving.

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Facebook:

Why you can't receive. You deflect compliments, refuse help, feel uncomfortable with gifts. You learned receiving is dangerous. But the inability to receive is a prison. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 206

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-21

LinkedIn:

Comparison is not envy. It is an unhealed deprivation.

You see someone who has what you want ? and something twists in your chest. You tell yourself you're jealous. You tell yourself to stop comparing. You tell yourself to be grateful for what you have.

But comparison is not envy. Envy wants what someone else has. Comparison is your system recognising that something you needed was missing.

When you see a man who is confident, and you feel that twist ? it is not envy of his confidence. It is grief for the confidence you were never allowed to develop.

When you see a man who is loved, and you feel that ache ? it is not envy of his relationship. It is grief for the love you didn't receive.

When you see a man who is successful, and you feel that sting ? it is not envy of his success. It is grief for the opportunities you never had.

Comparison is not a character flaw. It is a signal. It is your system telling you: something you needed was not provided. And it still hurts.

The work is not to stop comparing. The work is to follow the comparison to the deprivation underneath ? and to grieve what you didn't get.

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Facebook:

Comparison is not envy. It is an unhealed deprivation. That twist in your chest is not jealousy ? it's grief for what you never got. Follow the comparison to the wound underneath. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 207

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-22

LinkedIn:

The celebration you never got.

You achieved something. You worked hard. You succeeded. You did what was asked of you.

And nobody celebrated you.

Maybe they didn't notice. Maybe they noticed but didn't say anything. Maybe they said something but it felt hollow. Maybe they made it about themselves.

You learned to celebrate yourself. You learned not to need external validation. You learned to be your own cheerleader.

But the absence of celebration left a mark. A quiet hunger for someone to see you, to acknowledge you, to say 'I see what you did and I am proud of you.'

That hunger doesn't go away. It shows up in your need for recognition at work. In your need for your partner to appreciate you. In your need for your parents to finally acknowledge what you've become.

The celebration you never got is not about vanity. It is about the fundamental human need to be seen.

The work is not to stop needing celebration. The work is to give yourself the celebration you never got ? and to let yourself receive it when it comes from others.

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Facebook:

The celebration you never got. You achieved something and nobody saw it. That hunger for recognition is not vanity ? it's the need to be seen. Give yourself the celebration you never got. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 208

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-23

LinkedIn:

You feel guilty when things are going well. That is not gratitude.

Things are good. Life is stable. You have what you need. You should be happy.

But instead of happiness, you feel guilt. A quiet unease. A sense that this can't last. A feeling that you don't deserve this.

You tell yourself it's gratitude. You tell yourself you're just not taking it for granted.

But it's not gratitude. It is the scarcity wound speaking.

The scarcity wound says: good things don't last. The scarcity wound says: if things are too good, something bad is coming. The scarcity wound says: you don't deserve to have it this easy.

Gratitude is expansive. It allows you to enjoy what you have while it's here.

Guilt is contractive. It keeps you from enjoying what you have because you're waiting for the other shoe to drop.

If you feel guilty when things are going well, you are not grateful. You are scared. And the work is not to force yourself to be happy. The work is to heal the part of you that believes you don't deserve to have good things.

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Facebook:

You feel guilty when things are going well. That is not gratitude ? it's the scarcity wound. Gratitude is expansive. Guilt is contractive. Heal the part that believes you don't deserve good things. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 209

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-24

LinkedIn:

The scarcity that outlived the poverty.

The poverty is gone. You have enough. You have more than enough. Your children will never know the hunger you knew.

But the scarcity is still there. It lives in your nervous system. It shows up in the way you hoard resources, the way you can't enjoy what you have, the way you say no to yourself even when you don't need to.

The scarcity that outlived the poverty is the most insidious legacy of growing up without enough. Because it doesn't require the poverty to continue. It is self-sustaining.

Your children don't see the poverty. They see the scarcity. They see you refusing to spend on yourself. They see you worrying about money even when there is enough. They see you treating life as a zero-sum game.

And they learn it. They inherit the scarcity even though they never experienced the

poverty.

This is how intergenerational trauma works. Not through the poverty itself. Through the nervous system patterns that outlive the circumstances.

The work is not to pretend the poverty didn't happen. The work is to heal the scarcity in your nervous system so that it doesn't get passed down to the next generation.

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Facebook:

The scarcity that outlived the poverty. The poverty is gone but the scarcity lives in your nervous system. Your children inherit it even though they never experienced the poverty. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 210

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-25

LinkedIn:

Why giving is easier than receiving for Black men.

You will give until you have nothing left. You will give your time, your money, your energy, your attention. You will show up for everyone who asks.

But ask you to receive ? to accept help, to take a compliment, to let someone take care of you ? and something closes.

Giving is easier because giving is control. When you give, you are in charge. You are the provider. You are the strong one. You are the one who has something to offer.

Receiving requires vulnerability. It requires admitting that you need something. It requires trusting that the person giving doesn't want something in return.

For Black men, receiving is especially hard. We were raised to be providers. To be the ones who take care of others. To never be a burden. To never need anything from anyone.

But the inability to receive is not strength. It is a wall. And walls keep good things out as effectively as they keep bad things out.

The work is not to stop giving. The work is to learn that receiving is not weakness. That you can accept help and still be strong. That you are worthy of being taken care of ? even if you've never been shown that before.

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Facebook:

Why giving is easier than receiving for Black men. Giving is control. Receiving requires vulnerability. The inability to receive is not strength ? it's a wall that keeps good things out. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 211

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-26

LinkedIn:

What you tell your children about money is what your fear sounds like.

'Money doesn't grow on trees.' 'We can't afford that.' 'Rich people are greedy.' 'You have to work hard for every cent.' 'Don't waste money.'

You think you're teaching them values. You think you're preparing them for the real world.

But what you're actually teaching them is your fear.

Every statement about money that comes from scarcity is a statement about fear. Fear of not having enough. Fear of losing what you have. Fear of your children becoming entitled. Fear of them not understanding the struggle.

And your children learn the fear. They learn that money is scarce. That there is never enough. That wanting things is wrong. That the world is a place of lack.

They learn your scarcity even if they never experience your poverty.

The work is not to lie to your children about money. The work is to heal your own relationship with money so that what you teach them comes from wisdom, not from fear.

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Facebook:

What you tell your children about money is what your fear sounds like. 'We can't afford that' is not a lesson ? it's a transmission of scarcity. Heal your own relationship with money first. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 212

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-27

LinkedIn:

The man who doesn't believe he deserves a good life.

He works hard. He provides. He does everything right.

But he doesn't believe he deserves a good life.

He believes life is supposed to be hard. That suffering is normal. That if things are going well, something must be wrong. That he has to earn the right to be happy ? and he never quite earns enough.

This belief is not conscious. It is deeper than thought. It is a felt sense in the body. A knowing that good things are for other people, not for him.

It came from somewhere. From being told he was too much. From being made to feel like a burden. From being punished for wanting. From being taught that his needs don't matter.

And now he lives a life of quiet deprivation. Not because he can't have more. But because he can't let himself have more.

The man who doesn't believe he deserves a good life is not humble. He is wounded. And the

wound is not that he can't achieve ? it's that he can't enjoy what he achieves.

The work is not to achieve more. The work is to believe that you are worthy of what you already have.

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The man who doesn't believe he deserves a good life. He can achieve but he can't enjoy. The wound is not that he can't get more ? it's that he can't let himself have it. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 213

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-28

LinkedIn:

You don't have a partner problem. You have a vulnerability problem.

You think your relationship struggles are about your partner. She doesn't understand you. She's too emotional. She expects too much. She doesn't appreciate what you do.

But here's what I see: your relationship struggles are not about her. They are about your inability to be vulnerable.

You can't tell her what you need because you don't even know what you need. You can't express your feelings because you were never taught how. You can't be wrong because being wrong feels like annihilation. You can't apologise because apologising feels like weakness.

And so you withdraw. You deflect. You get defensive. You blame.

And she feels it. She feels the wall. She feels the distance. She feels that she is living with a man who is there but not there.

And she responds to that distance ? with frustration, with criticism, with withdrawal of her own.

And you think: see, she is the problem.

But she is responding to your wall. The wall was there before she arrived. The wall was built long before this relationship.

The work is not to find a different partner. The work is to take down the wall.

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You don't have a partner problem. You have a vulnerability problem. The wall was built before she arrived. The work is not finding a different partner ? it's taking down the wall. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 214

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-29

LinkedIn:

The silence that is killing your relationship.

You think silence is peace. You think not fighting means things are fine. You think keeping it to yourself is the mature thing to do.

But the silence is not peace. It is absence.

Every time you don't say what you need, the distance grows. Every time you swallow your feelings, the wall gets thicker. Every time you choose silence over honesty, you choose isolation over connection.

And your partner feels it. She feels the distance. She feels that you are not fully there. She feels that something is wrong but she can't name it because you won't name it.

And she starts to fill the silence with her own stories. 'He doesn't care.' 'He's not attracted to me.' 'He's hiding something.' 'I'm not important to him.'

The silence that you think is keeping the peace is actually creating a war. A war of assumptions. A war of unspoken resentments. A war that neither of you is fighting openly ? but both of you are losing.

The work is not to fight more. The work is to speak. To say the thing you're afraid to say. To break the silence before the silence breaks you.

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Facebook:

The silence that is killing your relationship. You think silence is peace. It's absence. Every unspoken thing builds a wall. Break the silence before it breaks you. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 215

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-30

LinkedIn:

You want her to see you. But you won't show her.

You want to be understood. You want to be known. You want someone to see past the facade and love what's underneath.

But you won't show her what's underneath. You keep the mask on. You keep performing. You keep being the strong, capable, unshakeable man you think she wants.

And then you feel unseen. And you resent her for not seeing you.

But how can she see what you won't show?

She is not a mind reader. She cannot love what you hide. She cannot know what you won't reveal.

The tragedy is: she probably can handle what's underneath. She probably already suspects it's there. She is probably waiting for you to trust her enough to show her.

But you won't. Because showing her means risking rejection. And risking rejection feels like death.

So you stay unseen. And you blame her for not seeing you.

The work is not to find someone who sees you without you showing yourself. The work is to have the courage to show yourself ? and trust that she will still be there when you do.

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You want her to see you. But you won't show her. She cannot love what you hide. The work is having the courage to show yourself ? and trust she'll still be there. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 216

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-08-31

LinkedIn:

The apology you owe yourself.

You've apologised to everyone else. You've apologised for your mistakes, your absences, your failures, your shortcomings.

But you've never apologised to yourself.

You've never said to the boy inside you: 'I'm sorry I treated you that way. I'm sorry I spoke to you with such cruelty. I'm sorry I expected you to be perfect. I'm sorry I never celebrated you. I'm sorry I made you feel like you weren't enough.'

You owe yourself an apology. Not because you did something wrong. But because you have been carrying a standard of self-criticism that you would never apply to anyone else.

You have been your own harshest judge, your own cruelest critic, your own most demanding taskmaster.

And you have never apologised for it.

The apology you owe yourself is not about letting yourself off the hook. It is about recognising that the way you have treated yourself is not okay. And that you deserve the same compassion you give to others.

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Facebook:

The apology you owe yourself. You've apologised to everyone else. But you've never said to the boy inside you: 'I'm sorry I treated you that way.' You deserve your own compassion. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 217

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-01

LinkedIn:

What happens when the provider stops providing.

This is the fear that drives so many men. The fear that if they stop providing ? if they lose their job, if their business fails, if they get sick ? they will lose their value.

Because their value is tied to what they provide. Not who they are.

And so they keep providing. Even when they're exhausted. Even when they're sick. Even when they're dying inside.

Because stopping means facing the question: if I am not providing, what am I?

This is why men struggle so much with retirement, with illness, with career transitions. It's not just about money. It's about identity.

The man who has built his entire identity on being a provider has no self left when the providing stops.

The work is not to stop providing. The work is to build an identity that is not dependent on providing. To know that you are valuable not because of what you do, but because of who you are.

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Facebook:

What happens when the provider stops providing. If your value is tied to what you provide, you have no self left when the providing stops. Build an identity beyond function. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 218

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-02

LinkedIn:

The man who can't say sorry.

He knows he was wrong. He knows he hurt someone. He knows an apology is due.

But he can't say it. The words get stuck. His throat closes. He deflects, justifies, explains, minimises ? anything but the simple words: 'I was wrong. I'm sorry.'

Why?

Because saying sorry feels like admitting that he is fundamentally flawed. Not that he made a mistake ? but that he IS a mistake.

For a man who grew up with conditional love, admitting fault feels like risking the relationship entirely. If I admit I was wrong, you will see how flawed I am. And if you see how flawed I am, you will leave.

So he can't say sorry. Because sorry feels like the end.

But here's what he doesn't know: the inability to apologise is what is actually destroying

his relationships. Not the mistakes. Not the faults. The refusal to acknowledge them.

The work is not to become perfect. The work is to learn that you can be wrong and still be loved. That an apology is not an admission of worthlessness ? it is an expression of respect.

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The man who can't say sorry. He knows he was wrong but the words get stuck. Because admitting fault feels like risking the relationship entirely. An apology is not weakness ? it's respect. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 219

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-03

LinkedIn:

You attract the level of intimacy you think you deserve.

This is hard to hear. But it is true.

If you believe, deep down, that you are not worthy of deep love, you will find partners who confirm that belief. Partners who are unavailable. Partners who don't see you. Partners who leave. Partners who confirm that you are not enough.

Not because you are unlucky. Not because there are no good partners. But because your nervous system seeks what is familiar. And what is familiar is what you learned about love in childhood.

If you learned that love is conditional, you will find conditional love.

If you learned that love is painful, you will find painful love.

If you learned that love requires you to disappear, you will find partners who make you disappear.

You attract the level of intimacy you think you deserve. Not the level you say you deserve. The level you actually believe you deserve ? in your body, not just your mind.

The work is not to find a better partner. The work is to change what you believe you deserve. To heal the part of you that thinks deep love is not for you.

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You attract the level of intimacy you think you deserve. Not what you say you deserve ? what you actually believe in your body. The work is changing what you believe you're worthy of. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 220

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-04

LinkedIn:

The fear of being known.

You want to be loved. But you are terrified of being known.

Because being known means being seen. And being seen means being vulnerable to rejection. If someone really knows you ? all of you, not just the performance ? they might decide you are not worth loving.

So you keep people at a distance. You share enough to seem open, but not enough to be truly known. You reveal your history but not your pain. You share your opinions but not your fears. You let people see your success but not your struggle.

And you wonder why you feel lonely even when you're surrounded by people.

You are surrounded by people who know the performance. But nobody knows you.

The fear of being known is the fear that if someone really sees you, they will leave. But here's the paradox: they are already leaving. Not because they see you ? but because they can't.

The distance you create to protect yourself is the very thing that keeps you from the connection you crave.

The work is not to eliminate the fear. The work is to let yourself be known despite the fear.

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The fear of being known. You want to be loved but you're terrified of being seen. The distance you create to protect yourself is the very thing keeping you from connection. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 221

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-05

LinkedIn:

What your father didn't teach you about loving a woman.

If your father was absent, you learned about loving women from trial and error. From media. From friends who also didn't know.

If your father was present but emotionally unavailable, you learned that love means providing, not connecting. That love means being present physically but absent emotionally.

If your father was harsh, you learned that love means control. That love means being right. That love means never showing weakness.

You learned what you saw. And if what you saw was not healthy, you are now trying to love from an incomplete template.

This is not your fault. But it is your responsibility.

The work is not to blame your father. The work is to learn what he couldn't teach you. To build a template for loving that is not based on absence, control, or performance.

To learn that love is not providing. Love is presence.

Love is not control. Love is trust.

Love is not performance. Love is vulnerability.

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Facebook:

What your father didn't teach you about loving a woman. You learned from what you saw. If the template was incomplete, the work is to build a new one ? based on presence, trust, and vulnerability. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 222

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-06

LinkedIn:

The relationship you're avoiding by focusing on work.

You work late. You check emails on weekends. You bring your laptop on holiday. You are always 'on.'

You call it ambition. You call it dedication. You call it providing for your family.

But what if it's avoidance?

What if the work is a refuge from the relationship? A place where you are in control, where you know the rules, where you are competent and respected?

What if staying late at the office is easier than going home and facing the distance between you and your partner?

What if the business you're building is also the wall you're hiding behind?

The relationship you're avoiding by focusing on work is not going to fix itself. It is not going to wait forever. The distance you create by choosing work over connection is accumulating. And one day, you will look up from your laptop and realise the relationship you were avoiding is gone.

The work is not to stop working. The work is to stop using work as a shield. To be present in your relationship ? not just financially, but emotionally.

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The relationship you're avoiding by focusing on work. You call it ambition. What if it's avoidance? The distance you create by choosing work over connection is accumulating. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 223

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-07

LinkedIn:

What you're passing down without knowing it.

You think about legacy in terms of money. Property. A business. A name.

But the real legacy is invisible. It is the nervous system patterns you pass down without knowing.

The way you react to stress. The way you avoid conflict. The way you disappear when things get hard. The way you criticise yourself. The way you can't receive love.

Your children are watching. And they are learning.

They are learning that love means performance. That feelings are dangerous. That rest is not allowed. That they have to earn their place in the world.

They are learning your wounds. Not because you want to teach them. But because wounds are contagious.

The work of healing is not just for you. It is for them. Every pattern you heal in yourself is a pattern you stop passing down.

The greatest gift you can give your children is not an inheritance. It is a healed father.

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Facebook:

What you're passing down without knowing it. Your children are learning your wounds. The greatest gift you can give them is not an inheritance ? it's a healed father. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 224

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-08

LinkedIn:

The father you're becoming is the father you needed.

You didn't have a template. You didn't have a model. You are building this from scratch.

And you are doing something remarkable: you are becoming the father you needed when you were a boy.

You are present where your father was absent. You are gentle where your father was harsh. You are curious where your father was dismissive. You are learning where your father was certain.

You are not perfect. You make mistakes. You lose your temper. You fall back into old patterns.

But you are trying. And that trying is everything.

The father you're becoming is not a reaction against your own father. He is not defined by opposition. He is defined by love. By the desire to give your children what you didn't

get.

And that is the most healing thing a man can do. Not just for his children. For himself.

Because every time you show up for them, you are also showing up for the boy you used to be.

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The father you're becoming is the father you needed. You're building this from scratch.

Every time you show up for them, you're also showing up for the boy you used to be. ?

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Post 225

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-09

LinkedIn:

What your children will remember.

They will not remember the things you bought them. They will not remember the house you provided. They will not remember the school fees you paid.

They will remember the way you looked at them. They will remember whether you were present. They will remember whether you were kind. They will remember whether you saw them.

They will remember the times you put your phone down and listened. They will remember the times you apologised. They will remember the times you chose them over work.

They will remember your presence or your absence. And that memory will shape how they see themselves, how they love, how they parent.

The things you think matter ? the provision, the success, the status ? are not what your children will carry. They will carry the feeling of being with you.

What will they carry?

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Facebook:

What your children will remember. Not the things you bought them. The way you looked at

them. Whether you were present. Whether you saw them. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 226

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-10

LinkedIn:

The cycle you think you've broken.

You are not like your father. You are present. You are gentle. You are emotionally available. You broke the cycle.

But have you?

Or have you just changed the expression of the wound?

Your father was absent. You are present ? but are you truly present, or are you just physically there while your mind is elsewhere?

Your father was harsh. You are gentle ? but are you gentle, or are you avoiding conflict because you're afraid of becoming him?

Your father was emotionally unavailable. You are open ? but are you open, or are you performing openness while still hiding the parts of yourself you're ashamed of?

The cycle you think you've broken might just be the same wound wearing different clothes.

The work is not to be the opposite of your father. The work is to be so fully yourself that there is no room for the cycle to continue.

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The cycle you think you've broken. You're not like your father. But have you broken the cycle ? or just changed the expression of the wound? The work is being so fully yourself that the cycle has no room to continue. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 227

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-11

LinkedIn:

What it means to leave something better than you found it.

Legacy is not about what you build. It is about what you leave behind in the people you touch.

You can build a business that crumbles. You can build a house that decays. You can build a name that is forgotten.

But if you heal yourself, if you show your children a different way to be a man, if you mentor a young man who had no father ? that legacy does not crumble. It multiplies.

The man who heals himself heals his ancestors. He changes the trajectory of his bloodline. He gives his grandchildren a starting point he never had.

Leaving something better than you found it does not require a building with your name on it. It requires the courage to do the work. To face your pain. To change your patterns. To become the man your lineage needed.

That is the only legacy that matters.

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What it means to leave something better than you found it. The man who heals himself heals his ancestors. He changes the trajectory of his bloodline. That is the only legacy that matters. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 228

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-12

LinkedIn:

The young man who needs you to be honest about your struggle.

There is a young man watching you. Your son. Your nephew. Your younger brother. The boy in your community who looks up to you.

He sees your success. He sees your strength. He sees what you've built.

But he doesn't see your struggle. He doesn't see the nights you doubted yourself. He doesn't see the failures you overcame. He doesn't see the healing you had to do.

And because he doesn't see the struggle, he thinks success is supposed to be easy. He thinks something is wrong with him because he's struggling. He thinks he's the only one who doesn't have it figured out.

The young man who needs you to be honest about your struggle doesn't need your perfection. He needs your truth.

He needs to know that the path is hard. That failure is part of it. That healing is ongoing. That being a man is not about having it all figured out ? it's about continuing to show up even when you don't.

Your honesty is his permission to struggle. And his permission to keep going.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The young man who needs you to be honest about your struggle. He sees your success but not your struggle. Your honesty is his permission to keep going. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 229

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-13

LinkedIn:

The grief of outgrowing your family.

You grew. You changed. You healed. You became someone your family doesn't fully recognise.

And now there is distance. Not because you love them less. But because you are not the same person they knew.

The conversations feel different. The values that once aligned no longer fit. The roles you used to play ? the fixer, the provider, the one who doesn't need anything ? no longer feel authentic.

And you grieve. You grieve the connection that was. You grieve the ease that is no longer there. You grieve the parts of yourself that you had to leave behind to grow.

This grief is real. And it is rarely spoken about.

Outgrowing your family is not betrayal. It is evolution. It is the natural consequence of doing the work.

But it is also lonely. And it requires a new kind of love ? a love that honours where you come from while accepting that you can no longer live there.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The grief of outgrowing your family. You grew, you healed, you became someone they don't fully recognise. Outgrowing your family is not betrayal ? it's evolution. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 230

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-14

LinkedIn:

The men who came before you are watching.

Your grandfather. Your great-grandfather. The men in your lineage who survived things you will never know.

They survived apartheid. They survived forced removals. They survived the migrant labour system. They survived poverty, violence, and a world designed to break them.

They did not survive so that you could stay small.

They did not endure so that you could play it safe.

They did not sacrifice so that you could live a life of quiet desperation.

The men who came before you are watching. Not with judgment. With hope.

They are watching to see if you will carry the baton further than they could. If you will heal what they couldn't heal. If you will become the man they were trying to become when the world got in the way.

You are not just living for yourself. You are living for them. And for the generations after you.

The work is not optional. It is ancestral.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The men who came before you are watching. They survived so you could carry the baton further. You are not just living for yourself ? you are living for them. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 231

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-15

LinkedIn:

The permission you've been waiting for.

You've been waiting for someone to tell you it's okay. Okay to feel. Okay to need. Okay to

rest. Okay to want something different. Okay to heal.

You've been waiting for permission from your father, who never gave it. From your mother, who couldn't give it. From your community, which doesn't know how.

But here's the truth: the permission you've been waiting for is not coming from outside.

It is not your father's to give. It is not your mother's to give. It is not your pastor's, your boss's, or your partner's to give.

The permission you've been waiting for is yours to give yourself.

And you can give it right now.

You can give yourself permission to feel what you feel. Permission to need what you need. Permission to rest without guilt. Permission to want something different. Permission to heal.

You don't have to earn it. You don't have to wait for it. You don't have to prove you deserve it.

It is yours. It has always been yours.

The only question is: will you take it?

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The permission you've been waiting for is not coming from outside. It's yours to give yourself. Right now. You don't have to earn it. The only question is: will you take it? ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 232

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-16

LinkedIn:

The man you are becoming is worth the work.

This is the last post in this series. One hundred posts about the things we rarely speak about. The wounds we carry. The patterns we repeat. The healing we avoid.

I wrote these posts because I believe something that is not popular to believe: that men can heal. That Black men, specifically, can heal. That the wounds of fatherlessness, of poverty, of a history designed to break us ? these wounds are not the end of our story.

I wrote these posts because I have seen it. I have seen men who were drowning in silence learn to speak. I have seen men who were trapped in anger learn to feel. I have seen men who were convinced they were broken discover that they were just wounded.

And I have seen what happens when a man heals: his children heal. His relationships heal. His community heals. The ripple effect of one man doing the work is incalculable.

The man you are becoming is worth the work. Not the man you were told to be. Not the man you perform for others. The man you actually are ? underneath the armour, underneath the performance, underneath the fear.

That man is worth fighting for. Worth healing for. Worth showing up for.

And he is waiting for you.

The work is hard. But you are not alone in it.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The man you are becoming is worth the work. One hundred posts about the things we rarely speak about. Men can heal. Black men can heal. The man underneath the armour is worth fighting for. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

Post 233

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-17

LinkedIn:

The wound is not that he left. The wound is that you turned his absence into a verdict on your worth.

"If only I had a dad around" ? you've said it. Maybe out loud. Maybe in the quiet moments when you're failing at something and you need someone to blame.

Here's what nobody tells you: the absence is real. The pain is real. But the story you built on top of it ? that you weren't worth staying for, that you missed some essential manual on how to be a man ? that story is a lie your inner child made up to make sense of the silence.

A 9-year-old cannot process abandonment. So he internalises it. He decides he must have done something wrong. He must not have been enough. And then he spends the next 30 years proving his worth to a man who isn't there to witness it.

The tragedy is not that your father left. The tragedy is that you've been trying to earn his approval ever since ? and he's not even in the room.

You don't need his permission to heal. You never did.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The wound is not that he left. The wound is that you turned his absence into a verdict on your worth. You don't need his permission to heal. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 234

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-18

LinkedIn:

You love him. But loving him feels like trying to hold water.

You show up. You communicate. You give him space. You try everything. And still ? he pulls away. He shuts down. He picks a fight over something small. He disappears emotionally for days and comes back like nothing happened.

And you wonder: what am I doing wrong?

Here's what you need to know: you're not doing anything wrong. He's not rejecting you. He's replaying a script that was written before you ever met him.

When a boy grows up without a father ? or with a father who was present but emotionally unavailable ? he learns that love is conditional. That people leave. That the safest thing is to leave first. That needing someone is dangerous because needing someone means you can be hurt.

So he tests you. Not consciously. But he tests whether you'll stay when he's difficult. Whether you'll still be there when he pushes you away. Whether you're like everyone else who left.

He's not trying to hurt you. He's trying to survive a wound he doesn't have words for.

This doesn't mean you accept mistreatment. It means you stop taking his patterns personally. And if he's willing to do the work ? if he's willing to look at the wound instead of just acting it out ? there is a way through.

But he has to choose it. You cannot love him healed.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

You love him. But loving him feels like holding water. He's not rejecting you ? he's replaying a script written before you met him. You cannot love him healed. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 235

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-09-19

LinkedIn:

You grew up wishing your father was different. Wishing he was present. Wishing he was gentle. Wishing he was the kind of man your friends' fathers were.

And now you're an adult. And you're still angry. Still disappointed. Still waiting for an apology that will never come.

Here's the part nobody prepares you for: your father was also a son. He was also a boy who grew up with wounds he never healed. He passed down what he had ? and what he had was broken.

This is not an excuse. This is context. And context matters because without it, you stay stuck in a child's rage ? waiting for a dead man to make things right.

The work is not forgiving him. The work is accepting that the father you needed does not exist. He never did. And he never will.

That grief is real. Sit with it. Let it break you if it needs to. But then ? build.

Build the man you needed him to be. Not by becoming him. Not by being the opposite of him. But by becoming someone who breaks the chain.

Your children will not wish you were different. Because you will have done what he could not: you will have looked at your wounds and chosen to heal them instead of passing them

on.

That is the inheritance worth leaving.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Your father was also a son. He passed down what he had ? and what he had was broken. The work is not forgiving him. The work is building the man your children won't have to wish for. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 236

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29

LinkedIn:

Most men don't need motivation. They need permission.

Permission to stop performing. Permission to admit they're tired. Permission to say 'I don't know what I'm doing' without losing their place in the world.

I see it every session. A man walks in carrying a version of himself he didn't choose ? the provider, the protector, the one who never cracks. And he's been holding that mask on for so long, he's forgotten there's a face underneath.

The work isn't giving him a new mask. It's giving him the courage to take the old one off.

This is what Men's Mental Health Month should be about. Not 'reach out if you're struggling.' But 'you can stop pretending now.'

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Most men don't need motivation. They need permission to stop performing. To admit they're tired. To say 'I don't know what I'm doing' without losing their place in the world. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 237

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-29 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The relationship you want requires a version of you that doesn't exist yet.

Most people wait until they're 'ready' before they pursue the relationship they actually want. But readiness is a myth. You don't grow into the person who can hold a healthy relationship by staying single and reading books. You grow into them by being in the relationship and failing forward.

The LoveBETTER Assessment doesn't wait until you're ready. It shows you where you are right now ? and gives you a map to where you're going.

7 domains. 14 pages. One honest starting point.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The relationship you want requires a version of you that doesn't exist yet. You don't grow into that person by waiting. You grow into them by starting where you are. The LoveBETTER Assessment gives you the map.

Post 238

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-30

LinkedIn:

I was a suicidal teenager.

Raised in a village where everyone knew everyone. Where mental health wasn't a conversation ? it was a weakness. Where the men in my life showed love through provision, not presence.

I don't share this for sympathy. I share it because there is a version of me that didn't make it. And I know there are men reading this who are living in that version right now.

What saved me wasn't a single moment. It was a series of small, unglamorous decisions. One conversation. One book. One person who saw me and didn't look away.

This is why I do this work. Not because I have it all figured out. But because I know what it feels like to believe you don't matter ? and I know that belief is a lie.

If you're in that place today: stay. One more day. One more conversation. One more chance to prove the lie wrong.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

I was a suicidal teenager. Raised in a village where mental health wasn't a conversation. What saved me wasn't one moment ? it was a series of small decisions. If you're in that place today: stay. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 239

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-30 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

Your attachment style is not your destiny.

I know this because I've watched people change theirs.

Not through willpower. Not through affirmations. Through something more boring and more powerful: repeated, corrective emotional experiences.

You don't heal an anxious attachment by being told to 'calm down.' You heal it by being with someone who doesn't punish your need for reassurance.

You don't heal an avoidant attachment by being told to 'open up.' You heal it by being with someone who doesn't weaponise your vulnerability.

The LoveBETTER Assessment identifies your attachment pattern ? and more importantly, it shows you what kind of relationship actually helps you heal it.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

Your attachment style is not your destiny. You don't heal it through willpower ? you heal it through repeated, corrective experiences. The LoveBETTER Assessment shows you what kind of relationship actually helps you grow.

Post 240

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-01

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it looks like everything else.

It looks like anger. Like irritability. Like shutting down. Like overworking. Like drinking too much. Like not being able to sleep. Like not being able to stay awake.

Most people who are grieving without support don't know they're grieving. They think something is wrong with them. They think they're broken.

You're not broken. You're carrying something that was never given space to land.

Grief wants to be witnessed. Not fixed. Not hurried. Not explained away.

If you've been feeling off and you can't name why ? ask yourself: have I given myself permission to grieve what I've lost?

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it looks like everything else. Anger. Irritability. Overworking. If you've been feeling off and can't name why ? ask yourself: have I given myself permission to grieve? ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 241

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-01 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

I've noticed something about the couples who actually heal.

They don't have fewer problems. They don't communicate better. They don't have more money or more time.

What they have is a shared framework.

They've stopped arguing about who's right and started looking at the same data. They've stopped guessing what the other person needs and started working from the same map.

This is what the LoveBETTER Assessment does. It doesn't fix your relationship. It gives you a language to talk about it ? together.

7 domains. Both partners. One report.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The couples who actually heal don't have fewer problems. They have a shared framework. The LoveBETTER Assessment gives both partners the same map ? so you stop arguing about who's right and start working together.

Post 242

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-02

LinkedIn:

Your father was also a son.

I know this is uncomfortable to hear. Especially if your father hurt you. Especially if he was absent. Especially if you're still angry.

But here's what I've learned from years of sitting with men: the father wound doesn't heal by blaming your father. It also doesn't heal by excusing him.

It heals when you see him clearly ? as a man who was also wounded, who also didn't know what he was doing, who also passed down what he was given.

Seeing him clearly doesn't mean forgiving him. It means understanding that his failure was not personal. It was inherited.

And if it was inherited, it can be unlearned.

That's the work. Not becoming him. Not being the opposite of him. But becoming someone who breaks the chain.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Your father was also a son. The father wound doesn't heal by blaming him or excusing him. It heals when you see him clearly ? as a man who passed down what he was given. And what was inherited can be unlearned. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 243

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-02 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The quality of your life is determined by the quality of your relationships.

This is not a self-help slogan. This is epidemiological fact.

Study after study shows that the single biggest predictor of health, happiness, and longevity is the quality of your close relationships. Not your income. Not your career. Not your diet.

Your relationships.

And yet most people spend more time planning their next holiday than they do understanding how they show up in relationships.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is 7 domains of clinical data about how you relate. It takes 20 minutes. And it might tell you more about yourself than years of guessing.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The quality of your life is determined by the quality of your relationships. This is epidemiological fact ? not self-help. The LoveBETTER Assessment gives you clinical data about how you show up in relationships.

Post 244

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-03

LinkedIn:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39.

At 9, silence kept you safe. You learned that if you didn't speak, you wouldn't get hit. If you didn't need anything, you wouldn't be disappointed. If you didn't feel, you wouldn't hurt.

At 39, that same silence is killing your relationships. Your partner doesn't know what you need because you don't even know. Your body is holding tension you can't name. Your anger comes out of nowhere because it's the only emotion you let through.

The strategy that kept you alive as a child is the strategy that's keeping you stuck as an adult.

The work is not judging that strategy. The work is thanking it for keeping you safe ? and then choosing a new one.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39. Silence kept you safe as a child. At 39, it's killing your relationships. The work is thanking that strategy ? and choosing a new one. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 245

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-03

LinkedIn:

Most people think therapy is about talking.

It's not. At least not primarily.

Therapy is about feeling. Specifically, it's about feeling things you've spent years not feeling.

Your body already knows what happened. It's been storing the memory, the tension, the unprocessed emotion. Therapy gives you a safe container to let those things surface ? not so you can analyse them, but so you can complete them.

This is why talk therapy alone often doesn't work for trauma. You can talk about something for ten years and still not heal it. Because healing happens in the body, not in the narrative.

Age Regression Therapy works with the body's memory. It doesn't ask you to tell your

story. It asks your nervous system to complete what it couldn't complete then.

That's the difference between managing a wound and healing it.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Most people think therapy is about talking. It's not. Therapy is about feeling what you've spent years not feeling. Healing happens in the body, not in the narrative. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 246

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-04 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The most expensive thing you can do is nothing.

I see couples who've been 'working on it' for five years. Same arguments. Same patterns. Same frustration. They've spent thousands on date nights, weekend getaways, relationship books. And nothing changed.

Not because they didn't try. Because they tried the wrong things.

You can't fix a communication problem with a date night. You can't heal an attachment wound with a holiday. You need data. You need a framework. You need to know what you're actually dealing with.

The LoveBETTER Assessment costs R600. That's less than a dinner out. And it will tell you more about your relationship than five years of guessing.

The question is not whether you can afford R600. The question is whether you can afford another five years of the same.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The most expensive thing you can do is nothing. Five years of the same arguments costs more than R600. The LoveBETTER Assessment gives you data instead of guessing.

Post 247

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-04

LinkedIn:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell.

No child is born angry. Anger is a secondary emotion ? it's the bodyguard for something more vulnerable underneath.

Underneath anger is usually: fear, hurt, shame, or helplessness.

When you yell at your partner, you're not angry at them. You're scared. Or you're hurt. Or you're ashamed. And you learned that yelling is the only way to get those feelings heard.

The work is not suppressing the anger. The work is getting underneath it ? to the need

that's been waiting to be seen.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell. Anger is the bodyguard for something more vulnerable. The work is getting underneath it. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 248

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-05

LinkedIn:

The quiet child was not fine.

He was not peaceful. He was not mature. He was not 'wise beyond his years.'

He was surviving.

He learned that if he stayed small, he wouldn't be a burden. If he didn't need anything, he wouldn't be disappointed. If he didn't make noise, he wouldn't get hurt.

And now he's an adult who can't ask for what he needs. Who apologises for having feelings. Who disappears in relationships because being seen feels dangerous.

The quiet child grew up. But he didn't heal.

Healing doesn't mean becoming loud. It means learning that your needs matter ? even when you whisper them.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics

fola.co.za

Facebook:

The quiet child was not fine. He was surviving. He learned that staying small kept him safe. Now he's an adult who can't ask for what he needs. Healing means learning your needs matter ? even when you whisper them. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 249

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-07-05 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

What if your relationship problems aren't a sign that something is wrong ? but a sign that something is trying to be healed?

I've sat with hundreds of couples. And the ones who heal share one thing: they stop seeing their problems as enemies.

They stop saying 'our communication is broken' and start saying 'our communication is showing us where we need to grow.'

This is not toxic positivity. This is a clinical reframe.

Every conflict is a signal. Every trigger is a teacher. Every pattern is a clue.

The LoveBETTER Assessment helps you read those signals instead of fighting them.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

What if your relationship problems aren't a sign something is wrong ? but a sign something is trying to be healed? Every conflict is a signal. The LoveBETTER Assessment helps you read it.

Post 250

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-15 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

You don't need another relationship book. You need a diagnosis.

Here's what I mean: when you go to a doctor with chest pain, they don't hand you a book about heart health and send you home. They run tests. They measure. They diagnose.

But when you walk into a relationship coach with 'we're not connecting,' they hand you a book.

That's the gap the LoveBETTER Assessment fills. 20 minutes. 7 clinical domains. A 14-page diagnostic report that tells you exactly where the disconnection lives ? not where you think it lives.

R600. One assessment. A starting point that actually starts.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

You don't need another relationship book. You need a diagnosis. The LoveBETTER Assessment is 20 minutes, 7 clinical domains, a 14-page report that tells you exactly where the disconnection lives. R600. lovebetter.co.za

Post 251

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-15

LinkedIn:

The version of you that learned silence is not the version of you that needs to lead.

I work with men who are CEOs, founders, executives. Men who run companies and manage teams. Men who are respected in their fields.

And many of them are still operating from the survival strategies they learned as boys.

They lead from control instead of trust. They make decisions alone because asking for help feels weak. They burn out because rest feels like failure.

The skills that got you to where you are are not the skills that will take you where you want to go.

The work is unlearning the survival strategies that are now holding you back.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
folaco.za

Facebook:

The version of you that learned silence is not the version of you that needs to lead. The skills that got you here are not the skills that will take you where you want to go. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 252

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-16 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

Most couples don't need to communicate better. They need to trust better.

I know this sounds counterintuitive. We've been told that communication is the key to a good relationship. But I've seen couples who communicate perfectly and still can't connect.

Because communication without trust is just information exchange.

Trust is not about knowing what your partner will do. Trust is about knowing that when they do something you don't understand, you'll give them the benefit of the doubt.

The LoveBETTER Assessment measures trust ? not just communication. It shows you where trust has eroded and what it needs to rebuild.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

Most couples don't need to communicate better. They need to trust better. Communication without trust is just information exchange. The LoveBETTER Assessment measures what actually matters.

Post 253

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-16

LinkedIn:

The mother wound in men is real. We just don't get to say it.

Men are not supposed to talk about their mothers with complexity. We're supposed to either revere them or reduce them. But the truth is more complicated.

Some men had mothers who were present but not attuned. Who loved them but couldn't see them. Who needed them to be fine ? so they were fine.

Some men had mothers who made them partners instead of children. Who leaned on them emotionally before they had the capacity to hold it.

And some men had mothers who did their best ? and it still wasn't enough.

Both things can be true. She did her best. And it still hurt.

The mother wound is not about blaming mothers. It's about giving men permission to grieve what they didn't receive ? without betraying the woman who gave them life.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

The mother wound in men is real. We just don't get to say it. It's not about blaming mothers. It's about giving men permission to grieve what they didn't receive ? without betraying the woman who gave them life. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 254

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-17 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The most underrated relationship skill is repair.

Not conflict resolution. Not communication. Not compromise.

Repair.

The ability to mess up, notice you've messed up, and come back to your partner with honesty instead of defensiveness.

Every couple fights. Every couple hurts each other. The difference between couples who make it and couples who don't is not the absence of harm ? it's the presence of repair.

If you can't say 'I hurt you and I'm sorry' without adding 'but...' ? that's the skill to work on.

The LoveBETTER Assessment measures your repair capacity. Because it matters more than whether you fight.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The most underrated relationship skill is repair. Every couple hurts each other. The difference is not the absence of harm ? it's the presence of repair. The LoveBETTER Assessment measures your repair capacity.

Post 255

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-17

LinkedIn:

The good child wound.

You were the easy one. The one who never caused trouble. The one who made your parents' life easier just by existing.

You learned early that your value was in how little you needed. So you stopped needing. You stopped asking. You stopped taking up space.

And now you're an adult who can't ask for a raise. Who says yes when you want to say no. Who apologises for having boundaries.

The good child grew up. But the wound remains.

The work is not becoming 'bad.' The work is learning that you can be good AND have needs. You can be kind AND have boundaries. You can be loved AND take up space.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

The good child wound. You were the easy one. You learned your value was in how little you needed. Now you're an adult who can't ask for what you want. You can be good AND have needs. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 256

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

I'm going to say something that might make you uncomfortable.

Most of the couples I work with don't actually need couples therapy.

They need individual healing that happens to benefit the relationship.

One partner has unhealed attachment wounds. The other has unprocessed grief. They're both showing up to the relationship with full backpacks ? and they're blaming each other for the weight.

The relationship isn't the problem. The relationship is the symptom.

The LoveBETTER Assessment doesn't just look at the relationship. It looks at each partner's individual patterns ? attachment, emotional regulation, self-worth ? and shows you where the real work is.

Sometimes the most loving thing you can do for your relationship is work on yourself.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

Most couples don't actually need couples therapy. They need individual healing that benefits the relationship. The LoveBETTER Assessment shows each partner where their real work is.

Post 257

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-18

LinkedIn:

Nobody checked in. So you stopped expecting it.

This is one of the most quietly devastating experiences of being a man.

You learn early that no one is coming to ask how you are. So you stop waiting. You build a life around not needing to be asked. You become self-sufficient to the point of isolation.

And then someone does ask ? and you don't know how to answer. The words don't come. The feelings don't have names. You've spent so long not needing that you've forgotten how to receive.

The work is not learning to need less. The work is learning that needing is human. And that the people who love you want to be needed.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

Nobody checked in. So you stopped expecting it. You built a life around not needing to be asked. The work is not learning to need less. The work is learning that needing is human.
? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 258

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-19 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about the father wound is that it doesn't feel like a wound.

It feels like normal.

You think every man has this distance from his emotions. You think every man struggles to connect. You think every man feels like he's performing masculinity.

You don't know it's a wound because you've never experienced anything else.

This is why assessment matters. You can't heal what you haven't named. You can't change what you haven't measured.

The LoveBETTER Assessment names it. Measures it. And gives you a pathway.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The most dangerous thing about the father wound is that it doesn't feel like a wound. It feels like normal. You can't heal what you haven't named. The LoveBETTER Assessment names it.

Post 259

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-19

LinkedIn:

What you thought was resilience was dissociation.

You didn't 'get through it.' You left your body.

When the trauma was too much, your nervous system did what it was designed to do ? it disconnected you from the experience. You went somewhere else. And when you came back, the danger was gone.

This is brilliant. Your body saved your mind.

But here's the problem: if you never came back fully, you're still living half-out of your body. You're still disconnected. You're still surviving ? not thriving.

True resilience is not the ability to disconnect. It's the ability to stay present ? even when it's hard.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

What you thought was resilience was dissociation. You didn't 'get through it' ? you left

your body. True resilience is not the ability to disconnect. It's the ability to stay present. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 260

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-20

LinkedIn:

The relationship you're avoiding by focusing on work.

I see this pattern constantly. A man throws himself into his career. Long hours. Big goals. Relentless ambition.

And underneath it all is a relationship he's afraid to face.

Maybe it's the relationship he's in ? and he knows it's not working but doesn't know what to do. Maybe it's the relationship he wants ? and he's terrified of rejection. Maybe it's the relationship with himself ? and he doesn't know who he is outside of his work.

Your career will not save you from your relationship problems. Success will not heal your attachment wounds.

The work is not choosing between career and relationship. The work is learning to hold both.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The relationship you're avoiding by focusing on work. Your career will not save you from your relationship problems. Success will not heal your attachment wounds. The work is learning to hold both. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 261

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-20

LinkedIn:

The grief of outgrowing your family.

You grew. You changed. You healed.

And now you don't fit anymore.

The conversations that used to feel normal now feel shallow. The dynamics that used to feel safe now feel suffocating. The people who raised you don't understand who you're becoming.

This grief is real. And it's lonely.

Because you're supposed to be grateful. You're supposed to be proud of how far you've come. And you are. But you're also grieving the connection you lost along the way.

Both things can be true. You can be grateful for your growth and grieving what it cost.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The grief of outgrowing your family. You grew. You healed. And now you don't fit anymore. You can be grateful for your growth and grieving what it cost. Both things can be true. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 262

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-21 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The man you are becoming is worth the work.

This is the end of Week 2. 14 posts. One honest conversation.

If something in these posts landed, here's what I want you to do:

1. Take the LoveBETTER Assessment. R600. 20 minutes. 7 domains. One honest starting point.
2. Book a discovery call. Free. 30 minutes. No pressure.
3. Or just sit with what came up. Let it land. Let it change something.

The work is not easy. But neither is staying the same.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The man you are becoming is worth the work. 14 posts. One honest conversation. Take the LoveBETTER Assessment. Book a discovery call. Or just sit with what came up. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 263

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-21

LinkedIn:

You learned love was performance.

If you were good enough, you'd be loved. If you achieved enough, you'd be seen. If you made no mistakes, you'd be safe.

This is the performance trap. And it's exhausting.

You've been performing for so long that you don't know who you are without the applause. You don't know what you want ? only what you're supposed to want. You don't know what you feel ? only what you're supposed to feel.

The work is not performing better. The work is letting yourself be seen when you're not performing at all.

That's terrifying. And it's the only way out.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

You learned love was performance. If you were good enough, you'd be loved. The work is not performing better. The work is letting yourself be seen when you're not performing at all.
? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 264

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-22 | Link: <https://folo.co.za/book...>

LinkedIn:

The Inner Child Healing Challenge starts in three weeks.

14 July 2026. 12 seats. 5 days.

This is not a course. It's not a webinar series. It's a structured clinical experience designed to help you reconnect with the parts of yourself you've been avoiding.

We start with the Inner Child ? the version of you that learned to survive. Then we move through the Father Wound, the Mother Wound, and into the Self.

By day 5, you'll have a clear picture of what's been running you from behind the scenes ? and a pathway to change it.

R2,500. 12 seats.

<https://folo.co.za/book>

Facebook:

The Inner Child Healing Challenge starts 14 July. 12 seats. 5 days. R2,500. A structured clinical experience to reconnect with the parts of yourself you've been avoiding.

Post 265

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-22 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The most expensive thing you can do is nothing.

I see couples who've been 'working on it' for five years. Same arguments. Same patterns. Same silence at the dinner table.

Five years of hoping it gets better. Five years of waiting for the other person to change. Five years of telling themselves they're trying.

They're not trying. They're waiting.

The LoveBETTER Assessment costs R600. Five years of staying stuck costs you your peace, your intimacy, and your time.

Which is more expensive?

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The most expensive thing you can do is nothing. Five years of staying stuck costs you your peace, your intimacy, and your time. The LoveBETTER Assessment costs R600. Which is more expensive?

Post 266

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-23 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

Your attachment style is not your destiny.

I know this because I've watched people change theirs.

Not through willpower. Not through affirmations. Through structured, measured work that starts with knowing where you are.

The LoveBETTER Assessment measures your attachment style across 7 domains. It shows you the patterns you didn't know you had ? and gives you a pathway to change them.

You don't have to be the same person in your next relationship that you were in your last one.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

Your attachment style is not your destiny. I've watched people change theirs through structured, measured work. The LoveBETTER Assessment shows you the patterns you didn't know you had.

Post 267

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-23

LinkedIn:

The quiet child was not fine.

He was not peaceful. He was not mature. He was not 'wise beyond his years.'

He was surviving.

He learned that his needs were a burden. That his voice was an inconvenience. That the safest way to exist was to take up as little space as possible.

And now he's a man who can't ask for what he needs. Who apologises for having feelings. Who disappears into work because being present in his own life feels too exposed.

The quiet child grew up. But the survival strategy stayed.

The work is not learning to be louder. The work is learning that your voice matters ? even when it shakes.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The quiet child was not fine. He was surviving. He learned his needs were a burden. Now he's a man who can't ask for what he needs. Your voice matters ? even when it shakes. ?
Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 268

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-24

LinkedIn:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39.

At 9, silence kept you safe. At 39, silence is starving your marriage.

At 9, anger got you left alone. At 39, anger is the only language you know for pain.

At 9, people-pleasing kept you loved. At 39, people-pleasing has left you empty.

The strategies that kept you alive as a child are now the walls keeping love out.

The work is not judging the child who learned to survive. The work is asking: is this strategy still serving me?

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The coping mechanism that saved you at 9 is destroying you at 39. Silence kept you safe then. It's starving your relationships now. The work is asking: is this strategy still serving me? ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 269

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-24 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

What if your relationship problems aren't a sign that something is wrong ? but a sign that something is ready to change?

Most people interpret conflict as failure. 'We're fighting again ? something must be wrong with us.'

But conflict is not the absence of love. Conflict is the presence of difference. And difference is not a threat ? it's information.

The question is not 'how do we stop fighting?' The question is 'what is this fight trying to tell us?'

The LoveBETTER Assessment helps you answer that question. Not by eliminating conflict ? by giving you the data to understand what's underneath it.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

What if your relationship problems aren't a sign something is wrong ? but a sign something is ready to change? Conflict is not the absence of love. It's information. The LoveBETTER Assessment helps you read it.

Post 270

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell.

No child is born angry. Anger is always secondary. Underneath it is something you were never taught to name.

Fear. Shame. Grief. Helplessness. Rejection.

When a child's needs go unanswered, the need learns to scream. By adulthood, the screaming has become a personality.

But it's not who you are. It's what you learned.

And what was learned can be unlearned.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

You don't have a temper. You have an unmet need that learned to yell. Anger is always secondary. Underneath it is something you were never taught to name. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 271

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-25

LinkedIn:

Most people think therapy is about talking.

It's not. At least not primarily.

Therapy is about feeling. About staying in your body long enough to process what you've been avoiding.

Most people talk to avoid feeling. They narrate their pain instead of experiencing it. They explain their childhood instead of feeling what it was like to be small and scared.

The work is not finding the right words. The work is finding the courage to feel what you've been running from.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Most people think therapy is about talking. It's not. Therapy is about feeling. About staying in your body long enough to process what you've been avoiding. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 272

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-26

LinkedIn:

Your father was also a son.

I know this is uncomfortable to hear. Especially if your father hurt you. Especially if he was absent. Especially if the wound he left is still open.

But your father was once a boy who didn't choose his circumstances either. He was raised by a man who was also wounded. And that man was raised by a man who was wounded too.

This is not an excuse. This is context.

Understanding the chain doesn't absolve anyone. But it does show you where the pattern lives ? and where it can be broken.

The cycle stops with the man who decides it stops with him.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

Your father was also a son. He was once a boy who didn't choose his circumstances either. Understanding the chain doesn't absolve anyone. But it shows you where the pattern can be broken. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 273

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-26 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The quality of your life is determined by the quality of your relationships.

This is not a self-help quote. This is clinical fact.

Decades of research ? the Harvard Study of Adult Development, attachment theory, interpersonal neurobiology ? all point to the same conclusion: the single strongest predictor of health, happiness, and longevity is the quality of your close relationships.

Not your career. Not your income. Not your achievements.

Your relationships.

And yet most people spend more time planning their next career move than understanding why their relationships aren't working.

The LoveBETTER Assessment is 20 minutes. R600. It might be the most important investment you make this year.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The quality of your life is determined by the quality of your relationships. This is clinical fact. The LoveBETTER Assessment is 20 minutes. R600. The most important investment you make this year.

Post 274

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-27

LinkedIn:

The fear of becoming him.

You've spent your whole life trying not to be your father. Every decision filtered through the question: 'what would he do ? and how do I do the opposite?'

You built a life in opposition to his shadow. You became gentle because he was harsh. You became present because he was absent. You became soft because he was hard.

But here's the trap: a life built in opposition to someone else is still a life built around someone else.

The work is not becoming the opposite of your father. The work is becoming yourself.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The fear of becoming him. You built a life in opposition to your father's shadow. But a life built in opposition to someone else is still a life built around someone else. The work is becoming yourself. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 275

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-27

LinkedIn:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it looks like everything else.

It looks like anger. It looks like withdrawal. It looks like overworking. It looks like addiction. It looks like the inability to commit.

Most men are not 'broken.' They're grieving. And they've never been given permission to do it out loud.

Unassisted mourning is what happens when a man carries loss alone ? loss of a father, loss of a childhood, loss of a dream ? and never gets to say it out loud in a room where someone holds it with him.

The grief doesn't disappear. It just changes shape.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
fola.co.za

Facebook:

The most dangerous thing about unassisted mourning is that it looks like everything else. Anger. Withdrawal. Overworking. Most men are not broken. They're grieving. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 276

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-28 | Link: <https://lovebetter.co.za...>

LinkedIn:

The man you are becoming is worth the work.

28 posts. 2 weeks. One honest conversation.

I started this because I believe that men deserve better than what we're currently being offered. Better conversations. Better tools. Better pathways to healing.

If you've read this far ? thank you. And if something in these posts landed, here's what I want you to do:

1. Take the LoveBETTER Assessment. R600. 20 minutes. 7 domains. One honest starting point.
2. Book a discovery call. Free. 30 minutes. No pressure.
3. Or just sit with what came up. Let it land. Let it change something.

The work is not easy. But neither is staying the same.

<https://lovebetter.co.za>

Facebook:

The man you are becoming is worth the work. 28 posts. 2 weeks. One honest conversation. Take the LoveBETTER Assessment. Book a discovery call. Or just sit with what came up. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA

Post 277

Status: pending | Scheduled: 2026-06-28

LinkedIn:

The wound is not that he left. The wound is that you turned his absence into a verdict on your worth.

You were a child when your father left. And children don't have the capacity to understand adult decisions. So they make up stories.

'He left because I wasn't good enough.'

'He left because I was too much.'

'If I had been better, he would have stayed.'

You've been carrying that story your whole life. It's been running your relationships, your career, your self-worth ? from behind the scenes.

The work is not finding out why he left. The work is letting go of the story you told yourself about why he left.

? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA Polyclinics
foa.co.za

Facebook:

The wound is not that he left. The wound is that you turned his absence into a verdict on your worth. You've been carrying that story your whole life. The work is letting it go. ? Hakeem Lesolang | FOLA
